MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Standards of Quality Session, Wednesday, October 20, 2021

Date	Wednesday, October 20, 2021
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	4h 13m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eSl1gssmSnk
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:11:29] - Apple time says it's one o'clock and therefore we can get started. I'm not quite sure, even Verizon agrees. So, welcome to everybody, thank you for being with us. This is the Committee on the Standards of Quality.

[00:11:45] As many of you know, I consider the Standards of Quality to be the most important thing that we do as a board, the constitutionally mandated thing that we do as a board. We're delighted to have with us, as always larger than life, Ms. Holton, beaming in on Zoom.

[00:12:04] I'd just like to note, two days ago, I guess, the Fredericksburg Freelance Star published an editorial which contained the following language. The Board of Education is pushing for an equity fund that would add to the add-on and help close the gap between the haves and have-nots.

[00:12:25] that has not yet been embraced by the legislature. It should be. Poor districts lose their best teachers to other localities. Facilities crumble for lack of funds. Kids are deprived of a chance at a good education. So, you know, I figure we're beginning to make it to the editorial pages of the newspapers around the state.

[00:12:46] We are making progress. With that, have all of you had a chance to read the minutes from the September 22 meeting? And if so, is there a motion to either adopt them as written or suggest revisions?

President Gecker, I move that the minutes of the September meeting be adopted with some minor editorial revisions, grammatical, et cetera.

[00:13:12] Okay. Do you want to specify those? No, they are – I don't have them up right now, but I think if they – just we go through one clean read, a fresh read, I think folks will catch them. There's some subject-verb agreement issues there, you know, so it's just the English teacher and me. Sorry. Okay. That's all right. Do we have a second?

[00:13:29] - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Duran. All those in favor, signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Okay, that carries. I guess you can work with, thank you, with our secretary, Dr. Lane, to get his English better.

[00:13:47] - All good. - It's all good. Some days you can't resist. Okay, public comment. Nobody signed up, but is there anybody in the audience who'd like to address the board or the committee at this point? I don't see anybody, so we will move on.

[00:14:04] Finalizing the 2021 prescriptions to the standards of quality, Dr. Sale and Deputy Superintendent Coy, Assistant Superintendent Coy, one of those. Well, good afternoon, President Gecker, members of the board, and Dr. Lane.

[00:14:20] It is my pleasure to be back in front of the committee here today in this last phase of our discussion around finalizing the 2021 prescriptions to amend the standards of quality. because we are at this junction and nearing the finish line, I think it's always helpful to quickly reflect on how we got to where we are here today. And this is really the product of several months of discussion around the 2019 board prescriptions, which were then reaffirmed in 2020, and reflecting on some of the progress that has already been made in the General Assembly. I think these discussions

[00:14:56] have been a really helpful and meaningful reminder about the tremendous amount of research, outreach, thought and discussion that went into the 2019 and 2020 prescriptions. Ultimately, the result of which was a package that supports our Virginia educators and better ensures equity of opportunity and outcome for our students. So with that in mind, the board aligned its resources with the demonstrated need. And of course, as we've discussed, we've since seen an even more punctuated argument for the need in our schools. So these are really aligned with, again, not just needs that we've recognizes the results of COVID, but longstanding needs in our school. So what remains for us here

[00:15:35] today and up on the slide is just a reaffirmation that the board has set the right markers within the existing set of prescriptions to make sure we're promoting meaningful outcomes here. So with that, we're going to touch on a handful of the prescriptions again, just to make sure that we've set the right scale. The first item we're going to bring back for discussion is the work-based learning coordinator item and here we have a very simple slide which reflects on what we heard from the board in previous months about an express interest to expand capacity to support the

[00:16:13] implementation of the profile of the virginia graduates we heard about it and discussed different ways that we might approach this as a proposal and thought about maybe incorporating this into other prescriptions and talking about elevating and enhancing or maybe providing more prescriptive direction and spaces like student support personnel positions and their job responsibilities but ultimately where we landed was with something that again kind of created a standalone for the work-based learning coordinators recognizing the specialized need for these positions but the outstanding question for us here

today is recognizing although we already recognize a need for coordination with our work-based learning positions at what level would we be

[00:16:53] best suited and best served so in that first column there you see their current prescription which is the regional level model which has one state coordinator position and eight regional coordinators based at the virginia department of education we do know that this is actually currently being implemented through support from federal perkins funding and the reason for this particular model as we now well know in what informed the board's decision in 2019 and 2020 again is a need for coordination and this particular model focuses on that cross division collaboration and coordination components so the alternative to this model and the regional based model would be

[00:17:31] a position at each division so a division level model of course right now this is in proposal only form and something for the board to consider here today but what we would share from a staff perspective is that the division model doesn't necessarily preclude cross-division coordination which was one of the the reasons and kind of impetus behind the regional level model but it does allow additional infrastructure and capacity at the division that gives divisions targeted and supports um for their individual student populations um so in that way there is some expanded capacity if if they were to pursue the division level model the cost for the regional

[00:18:09] level model as we know is the 1.2 million um moving to the division level would of course require some additional personnel on that being 132 um new positions across the state um which does have a cost of 7.8 million. I'll pause right there just for you all to take a look at this slide, but wanted to give a brief overview of the difference between those models. And of course, we can circle back at the end for questions and consideration. And perhaps I should also pause for the president to see if he would like to take these one item at a time, or of course, we can circle back to all of our decision points at the end. I just assume take them one at a time

[00:18:45] here and go through, make a decision, and then we'll be done when we're done. Absolutely. Well, then the pause was timely um so we can reflect on that proposal question please dr wilson dr sale is the 7.8 net of the 1.2 already in the regional model or is that additive to the 1.2 what what happens to the 1.2 in the regional so it doesn't take into account the 1.2 it's not an additional 7.8 that would be the total state impact disregarding the one disregarding thank you

[00:19:16] anybody else are there any thoughts on uh you know this topic the work-based learning coordinator topic which way we ought to go here mr president can you hear me yes so i was one who was pushing for more on this but i've miss dr sales has convinced me last time uh that and all of you have helped convince me that uh if we're continuing to push for more counselors on our other prescriptions

[00:19:54] the counselor ratios maybe that's the better solution because counselors should be helping with work-based learning among there are many other uh duties dr robertson and i was wondering if uh we have have any input from the field regarding whether the regional model or the division model would be preferred i think we we can all imagine that if we could invest in every school system in the state that would be wonderful um but i don't know if we've received input

[00:20:33] from the field about that would be a priority we haven't received any feedback specific to this proposal or the difference in the two respects yeah dr man yes i know i also spoke to this at the prior meeting and just um i i think i heard and i have an appreciation for the tensions that we have to balance as we think about these um prescriptions and the resources that come with

[00:21:05] them. And I guess on the one hand, I certainly understand the value of wanting to ensure that there is a regional approach to leveraging talent and not focusing solely district by district across the Commonwealth. I think that, of course, is prudent and wise. I guess my challenge is that when you think about regional versus division, there's a great chasm between the two approaches

[00:21:44] because I really am struggling to think about how an exclusive regional model is truly going to support the intention behind what the profile of a Virginia graduate contemplated around how we're supporting this work transition for our students. And so it's difficult for me to kind of like reconcile that. I think that it is insufficient to imagine that there's going to be

[00:22:18] enough progress with a regional model alone. And I understand the concern around wanting to make sure that districts are taking a regional approach and things are not being addressed in a silo fashion because we are talking about workforce and certainly in the northern virginia area regional workforce dynamic is very much a part of what's what's true for our economy and so where's the middle ground i guess i'm i because i really do struggle with the um i i heard the

[00:22:58] concern that surfaced but i i am still struggling because the capacity for people to just have more and more added to their plates and we imagine that we're going to make progress on things that have been prioritized is i'm challenged by it well okay from my perspective on this i would say we got sold but we certainly investigated the regional level model we have not really had anything brought

[00:23:34] before the board that shows what more the division level model would bring in terms of you know the outcomes we desire and so at this point you know i would prefer we stay with the regional level model in the standards as opposed to the division level model uh and as we move forward and if we see where there are gaps that need to be filled in the individual divisions i think at that point we address it but again it's it's almost like we're you know scrapping something before we've

[00:24:09] actually used it and gathered any evidence to see what the effectiveness is. I understand the impetus for the division level and the concept that it will in fact produce more, but frankly we have no idea yet what the regional level model will produce. I would be prepared to stay with that in the current prescription of the SOQs.

[00:24:33] President Decker, to that point, Dr. Lane, what was the year that we actually started deploying the regional level model we've just done that but is it was it end of 20. i believe the positions have been hired in the last calendar year so it's there's not really data to to show i will share one thought on this from my perspective um the i wonder if the board wants to retain this in the standards of quality at all since it's being funded under perkins

[00:25:11] and then question question two is part of my reason for thinking if you're not going to go at the division level model that you might remove it all together is we have we have this would be the first time if adopted under the code that standard two would include personnel at the department instead of just at the division level and and just uh wondering if the board still wants to remain with that priority being that we're funding it in other ways on the devil's advocate

[00:25:45] side of that, you know, we really have as a board not been as concerned with the source of funding as it is with the results we're looking to achieve. You know, I understand your point that maybe we ought to take it out because it is Perkins funded, but, you know, where then do we ensure, if not here, that the framework that supports the profile of a graduate actually gets

[00:26:18] done you know through the department or otherwise i mean we changed the perkins formula for this right i understand and i think that you can mandate that it gets done in your supervisory role and and maybe in other places i i again my my concern is more you're essentially requesting the general assembly to fund something you're already funding we are already funding and you know is that necessary to move forward to them and then if so are you sure that you want to

[00:26:54] start a precedent of of identifying department of ed positions in the standards of quality versus school division positions so mr president may i chime in please yeah i i think dr lane makes a good point and i would offer that if we're going to start prescribing positions other than at the division level is this really the one that we want to jump in on with you know or do we want to be more thoughtful about that in a future round and second of all i think that once this once this is

[00:27:29] down if we're in agreement that we're going with the regional model it's just almost not big enough to merit it it could be potentially distracting in our soq prescriptions overall let's let's keep the focus on the big thing i i agree with that comment from miss holton and i do support sticking with the regional model and i do think it can be distraction we haven't got to our other topics in MSLQ, but I think those should be the ones we want to highlight, particularly if this is being funded already through the Perkins grant.

[00:27:59] So I would support what you were just saying, Ms. Holton. Go back for a second to the question, how do we ensure that the Perkins money will in fact be used for this? Because, you know, candidly, we would, I don't think, have voted to change the Perkins formula had this not been, had the regional workforce model not been put before us as this is what's going to happen.

[00:28:25] If this just becomes DOE dollars or BDOE dollars, you know, what leverage is there except for the SOQs to ensure that what we intended to happen actually happens? We have no direct supervisory control over BDOE. You approved the Perkins plan.

[00:28:42] So what you're saying next year, if you don't do it, we will have to change the Perkins plan? So the way the Perkins plan was written is you created a new reserve fund. Right. We didn't change the formula. And in the new reserve fund, you identified the reserve fund as the source for this funding.

[00:29:02] We cannot revise that and use it on other purposes without your permission. We did change the formula to the extent that the DOE is getting more and the community colleges are getting less. And I know, not in terms of aggregate dollars, because the theory is that the inflator will take care of that.

[00:29:24] But in terms of the percentages, we definitely changed the percentages here. There was a new funding source, and we put that new funding source towards the reserve. But yes, the community college wanted a larger percentage, and the board did not.

[00:29:39] Again, in reliance upon the idea that this money would be used for the regional workforce to support the profile of the graduate. Right, and we are doing that as the board intended and as approved under the plan.

[00:29:55] You are doing it today, but again, the question here is, what is the mechanism by which the board ensures that the reason we made those changes actually gets carried out. Let's say you're not here next year, or we're not here next year. You know, it's, we believe, I think as a board, you know, or this wouldn't have made it to this level, that having some coordination that is geared around workforce development and support of the profile of a graduate is important. And

[00:30:29] what you're saying is, you know, don't put it in here because we're funding it, you know, through Perkins and with DOE positions. But it doesn't, you know, we still need to reflect somewhere the importance of this and really the mandate of it. And my point is, both of my points are intended to go together that I agree that the board needs to have clear direction on how they leverage this workforce opportunity. But I believe that we are funding it under Perkins. And I have some concern about funding Department of Ed positions through the standards of quality when

[00:31:09] the standards of quality at least in standard two are so focused on school division positions not sure i share that although i would like to ask you know miss williams at some point can we get some idea about you know how restricted the dollars are from the perkins money you know do we have assurance that what the board did there will in fact be used for the purpose the board intended he goes frankly if we don't have control there i think it's gotta it's gotta be

[00:31:42] somewhere no i know i'm not asking for it now i just ask yeah you know sometime soon if we could have a read on what the leverage is here and you know whether or not what we did actually ensures that it happens or whether it just gave a pot of money to uh vdoe to not do with whatever they want because there are some restrictions to it but not necessarily to set up the regional network if they feel like there's something else they could be doing uh that might be better we'll confirm my gut is that you would have to revise the plan for us to use it for other purposes which you could do

[00:32:21] and future boards could do that's fair point anybody else have anything on this would it be correct to assume that again leaving the funding point to the side for the minute that as a board the consensus is uh that for now we would go with regional as opposed to division level workforce coordination see a lot of nodding so we're not going to take a vote on it but i think you know

[00:32:54] that would be the way to go in the plan subject to the funding issue okay yes thank you and on the issue whether it remains an sq though well that that is uh i would like to understand more francisco about how forceful our changing of the purpose plan was toward carrying out this goal if we find for example that what we did ensures that this occurs i think i'm okay with leaving it out of of the SOQs. If we find, however, that we just created a fund of money that could be used for

[00:33:30] other things, it's not as clear to me that it ought not be somewhere in what the board mandates. I would agree with you on that as well. So what's the next steps for finding that? I asked the AG's office to figure out what the answer is to that question. I've heard what Dr.

[00:33:52] Elaine says, I just want to understand fully that the Perkins plan changes we made ensures the coordinators, even though they're VDOE employees. And as you know, we have no direct control over VDOE. Although we're considered supervisory, we're really legally not.

[00:34:10] So tomorrow, though, correct me if I'm wrong, we're acting on the final action for the SOQ. Is that correct? Yeah. So will we be able to have this information? We hope so. Okay. So tomorrow we should expect when this comes up, maybe we'll have some more information on that. Yes. Thank you.

[00:34:30] Sure. I will carry that back with our item tomorrow. All right. And it's at-risk add-on. And we heard, as you all recall, at the last meeting, some public comments from folks in the audience that asked the board to reflect, or rather they reflected on some of the approaches that we've seen from other states and how they've provided a more equitable approach to their funding models and what it takes to support our students in those highest areas of concentrated poverty.

[00:35:03] The board asked for us to take a look at our existing enhanced at-risk add-on model. So what staff thought would be most helpful for us as part of this continued discussion is to look at what informs the current model. And we broke that into two different pieces.

[00:35:19] First is the design of the enhanced at-risk add-on program, Which, as you've seen here, this proposal leverages our existing at-risk add-on funding model, which creates a scaled add-on amount depending on the level of free lunch students in a division's population.

[00:35:35] But building on this and actually improving on this model, we are consolidating multiple at-risk funding streams to create a single pot of money to support our at-risk students in areas of the highest concentration of poverty. We are also, through this revised model, improving or rather removing qualifiers for funding that minimize the variation that we see from our higher income areas and lower income areas.

[00:36:02] And in creating the single pot, which means a single set of parameters for how the funding can be used, you're simultaneously creating some flexibility and intentionality in this funding. So making sure that school divisions have a larger pot of money that they can direct and target in more flexible ways, but making sure it's going to the right places and being thoughtful in those uses.

[00:36:23] For example, making sure that we are spreading high quality teachers across the division and making sure they're paired with the students that need those the most. So in reflecting on that individual piece of design, we did think that that was a strong proposal in the way that it was formulated.

[00:36:38] And so we took a look at the amounts that are a part of the enhanced risk add-on program. We're on the right side there. We revisited our research, which, as we know, confirms the disparities and how we spend money in high poverty areas versus low poverty areas.

[00:36:56] And that is a national trend as well as a trend that we see here in Virginia and how that money is directed to those students most in need. um our research also pretty uniformly confirms the fact that it takes more money and we need additional funding to support those students in areas of higher poverty to make sure that they are achieving the outcomes we would like them to see or we would like to see um but because of the confounding variables in these different research and the different baselines for the per pupil amounts um we found that there was no not necessarily a single number or a single amount um that it equated to to what we would consider kind of a threshold or meaningful outcome

[00:37:36] and we see here that some advocate for different percentages of add-ons some advocate for flat rates but of course this all was dependent on a number of variables for example urban versus rural areas um and and a number of different kind of baseline um confounding variables there so with all of that in mind and and recognizing that there's not necessarily a standard number across the board that the research recommends we went back to the current virginia model and realize that the 1 to 26 percent that's currently in place with the existing at-risk add-on would still see significant or we would still see significant improvements with the

[00:38:13] existing proposal which would increase the add-on range from 10 to 65 percent and that's another pause point for us to reflect on that enhanced at-risk add-on and of course whether we feel like we have the correct scale for our add-on amounts there any comments here miss holton thank you uh thank you dr sales uh i hear you saying um your slide gives examples of two states that i think do well in this work and that's maryland 35 and massachusetts 50 to 100 obviously

[00:38:53] that depends somewhat on how adequate the base funding is to start with and that's an important point but then i'm having a hard time comparing apples to apples to that to what we are either already doing in virginia or what our current proposed prescription would do so our current number is one to 26 percent uh the prescription we're looking at is 10 to 55 but those are the ranges do we have any sense of what the average is that would be a number that compare apples to apples to maryland or massachusetts if i'm making sense yeah i i believe i understand the question

[00:39:32] And I don't know if we do have a perfect number that would make it an apples-to-apples comparison. I think, like I said, as we reflected on kind of the different variables that were input into these kind of research components and reflecting on the different states and circumstances in the baseline, we didn't necessarily have kind of what we would consider an equivalent to be applied to the Virginia model.

[00:39:54] Well, I'm just frustrated by that because I don't know, you know, if we have a 10 to 55% range, say, or take our existing range one to 26 if virtually all divisions are at the one percent end of that range then that's you know where we really are and the 26 is just the outline and if they're really all at the 26 in range and only a very few districts get the one percent then that just tells me a really different thing so 10 to 50 both of those ranges are so big that i don't know where

[00:40:28] to you know if if 10 to 55 percent if the districts are spread pretty evenly if the students are spread pretty evenly from 10 to 55 percent then that means we're maybe somewhere around 35 percent in our prescription which is where maryland is but you know so i'm i'm at a loss to have a sense of whether what we're prescribing in terms of the size increase for the at-risk add-on is enough so with regard to uh we we have run the numbers and we could look at them if you wanted an average

[00:41:04] or to understand the distribution of where divisions fall um in that breakdown i don't have it at the tip of my fingers but i think and i'm looking at it over there i think that we can pull that for you if you wanted to know how the divisions fall across that existing range and against the proposed range yes and we can do that that would be you know and maybe it's just too late to try to do that for this round this year but um i thought that was what i've been asking and i will say even i mean i know it's complicated i mean what do you do an average of the district

[00:41:39] percentage right because it is a district level percentage right i think not a school level percentage and you know that we don't average the district that serves five it doesn't really help to average a district that serves 500 students with fairfax that serves 180 000 but you know So maybe a distribution curve would be more helpful, or I don't know what, but somehow help us get a sense of whether what we're recommending is adequate.

[00:42:08] And we might have some support on the way. I'll come to this, Mike, Ms. Holton. We do have Ed Lanza sitting in the back here from our budget office, and he has shared that the straight line average for the board proposal is 39.44% statewide.

[00:42:29] so hopefully that is helpful that means an average of you know taking 130 divisions correct it's a division the division level data point yeah okay well that at least gives it some kind of ballpark and that sounds like we're you know at least some indicator that we're in the range right range thank you any other comments questions miss holton do you have a suggestion

[00:43:04] here move it forward or well i i mean i i don't really feel like we i mean i think that was helpful for me to understand that we're at the 10 to 55 range with a 39 division level average is at least that gives us

an add-on in the spirit of where maryland is and i have seen research that would suggest the heart is at least it may well be that we need much more but for this year's purposes i think that we probably need to go forward with this i i would ask that as for the next round that

[00:43:43] we do this that we try to get a more granular uh uh indicator of how this is impacting you know you know a weighted average if i'm sorry that can help inform efforts uh going forward but uh for now i do think this is one of the most important of our recommendations and uh i don't i don't want to muddle the waters unduly here at the final hour so i I suggest we move forward on it.

[00:44:13] Long-winded way of saying, sorry. - Yeah, that's helpful. Is there anybody who disagrees with the idea or who wants to add to the concept of moving forward on this one? Dr. Robertson. - I'm fine with moving forward, but I do think that unless someone knows differently, I feel that we don't yet have sufficient data to know what we're aspiring to do.

[00:44:39] I would like to know what the end game is in terms of the percentage that's selected, and perhaps that can come over the next year or so, as Ms. Holton is suggesting. I would just give some oomph to that desire to know what our goal should be.

[00:44:59] - Thank you. - Anybody else? - No, doctor. - I'm fine moving forward. I'll just reiterate what I said last time, though I do think that I wish that we could long-term look at how we identify individual schools based on their population rather than the division aggregate, And there are some models out there that do that, but I do feel that there are some schools in high school divisions that their aggregate data shows that they are, you know, higher free and reduced lunch population at the division level, but in their individual pockets.

[00:45:34] So I think that that's an inequity that occurs in this. We talked about that last time. I understand all the nuances to it. I understand all the next steps that have to be put in place. just want to once again say publicly i feel that that's something we must consider and think about for those schools in larger divisions and particularly this impacts northern virginia um i think every school division in northern virginia pretty much maybe not one has this as a challenge and as an issue for any type of funding that comes forward so i just want to reiterate that and it's something that long term i hope that we will find ways to work through that

[00:46:08] nuance because it does have impacts on certain schools in those divisions but having said that i do support moving this forward yeah dr wilson um thank you for for all of the information and i do also support moving forward though i have a question and i know this you have answered this before so forgive me for asking again but your second bullet here or third bullet actually talks about minimizing the divisions that may lose funding so we are acknowledging that there will be some loss of funding somewhere and so just thinking about how that looks on the ground

[00:46:48] how many divisions are we talking about of course we don't we don't have it all in hand perhaps just yet but we likely have some idea right and so can you give us some general understanding of how many divisions may we see that would lose funding under this particular model zero okay i see a zero from the gallery over here when you're talking about minimizing um the potential for losing funding talking about in generalities but the goal of the existing range um one of the parts of the design that we kept in mind was that no no individual school division would see a loss in

[00:47:28] funding based on this so then this third bullet is not necessary doesn't should not suggest that there will be loss, but the idea is that none would lose. Yes, the third bullet mentions one of our considerations was the ultimate range where we landed, making sure no one did.

[00:47:44] Thank you. Thank you. Yes, that's good news. Okay. So on this one, the consensus is we move on, and to, I guess, Dr. Duran's point, I'm fully supportive of the idea that we ought to refine this to school level at some point.

[00:48:02] I will say that when we first did this in 2019, it was relatively groundbreaking and a decision was made to, you know, not upset everything in terms of funding concepts in the Commonwealth, but to move forward with some very targeted approaches to how do we get, you know, different teachers in front of kids.

[00:48:27] you know, but as we evolve here, I think next year would be a good time for us to begin looking at what's being done elsewhere and how we can refine the model in Virginia to be more targeted to the school level. Okay. So again, consensus is we move on with this one. Dr. Sale. All right. Our second to last item or point of reflection here is how we're supporting our English learners in the existing SOQ prescriptions. If you will recall, this conversation was also prompted in part by

[00:49:03] our public comments and reflecting on how some other states provide support to their English learners. But it was also prompted in part by our discussion about elevating certain prescriptions as we think about how to advance the SOQ package. And so in light of that, the board had requested to better understand what we're seeing in terms of English learner outcomes and the need to continue to highlight this item given some of the progress that we've already seen in the general assembly. And to quickly highlight where we currently are, in 2019, when the board had

[00:49:37] originally prescribed their EL ratio, the staffing ratio in the standards of quality was actually at 17 to 1,000. So you'll see here from the current standards of quality language, we have seen some movement in terms of improving and increasing the ratio of instructional supports for our English learners. And last school year, there was the requirement to go from 17 to 18.5 full-time positions with this year being 20 to a thousand full-time position per student.

[00:50:06] What the biggest difference is in the current or the current prescription in front of the board is this differentiation component. So while there is a recognized need to make sure there's more instructional supports available to these students, who are they serving and how we're directing those instructional supports to those lower proficiency levels is of utmost importance here.

[00:50:27] So that is an outstanding difference in what we see in the current SOQ language versus the board's prescription. So as we continue our conversation about elevating the English learner prescription and the importance of this, and given the progress that we've seen already made, the question is, is there a need to still carry this proposal forward and elevate it as one of the board's priorities?

[00:50:52] Or I guess one of the items highlighted as part of the board's prescription package. And what the data has told us is yes, that's the case. is a kind of threefold reason first the number of english learner students in the commonwealth we've seen increase year over year we continue to see achievement gaps between our level or the level of proficiency for our english learners and we'll reflect on this a little bit more in forthcoming slides and something else that we know is that there's a stagnation in growth at certain levels of proficiency that so to move from an english learner to a former english learner

[00:51:28] and move into the level of proficiency that that deems you proficient um it's difficult to do um to make that transition and so we do see our students stagnating at the higher levels of proficiency but not proficient and again just some data to highlight this for you all um and i will start just providing by providing this context slide which gives english learner students by proficiency level in the commonwealth and this is as of the 2018-2019 school year um some key takeaways from this particular slide is first again just context for um the number of students that we're going to

[00:52:04] see in each proficiency level and their achievement in the forthcoming slides um but because of the way that the differentiator differentiation model is is laid out in your prescription um the additional instructional support um will be directed to a critical mass of english learner students so 73 of english learners fall in that level one level two and level three proficiency level so we would see significant supports again being provided to the critical mass of english learners through differentiation we do see a difference in our the level of proficiency and

[00:52:43] our pass rates um i think this graph is pretty intuitive and speaks for ourselves but our lower proficiency el's are not performing as well on our sol reading assessments um so of course the inverse of that is also true where we see our higher proficiency levels um having higher reading pass rate so again the importance of differentiation here and you'll see in the graph i know it's hard to read up on the slide but this does reflect pass rates for the grade 3 reading sol the grade

[00:53:11] 8 reading sol and the end of course or end of course tests and 11th grade also in line with those findings is that we find our lower level proficiency el's are more likely to drop out than those higher level proficiency el's and of course the inverse also being true there that our higher level proficiency students are more likely to complete high school either via a certificate

[00:53:39] of completion or a diploma with all that being said we know the importance of differentiation in our english learners and how we provide instructional supports but as staff reflected on this information and some of the things that we we read and understood about that stagnation at those higher level of proficiencies we did recognize an opportunity to make a small adjustment to the current prescription which we have here in front of us today and you'll see it's a very small edit but a meaningful edit and that last line for where all other english language learner students

[00:54:19] would have an instructional ratio of one position per 58 students that's the current prescription and the amendment would bring that to 1 to 50. and the reason for that is with the current increase in instructional positions for el learners we wanted to make sure that the board's soq prescription didn't see any instructional positions being removed from those supporting those higher proficiency levels so this again ensures no fewer instructional positions at the higher level than currently required which is that 20 to a thousand model and this is an another point of

[00:54:54] inflection for us to to think about the english language learner prescription um and where the board's current prescription stands and whether there's interest um in in taking that this next step thank you thank you so much for that inclusion of additional data i think that there has been much progress made as we saw in the last legislative assembly but what we need to make sure is that with this time if we move i hope that we'll move this forward you know i strongly believe this should be included that we tell the story about the why we acknowledge the progress

[00:55:29] but we go deeper to understand help our legislators understand why we continue to include this is because we see the impact from a data perspective around a clear equity issue across the

commonwealth and data point after data point which you highlighted here and then there are a few others show that our english learners particularly those at level one and two are the most impacted across the state in terms of success whether it's graduation whether it's assessments whether it's dropping out whether it's attendance there's also some discipline data we can look at into a variety of things mental health challenges as we look at many of those level one and two

[00:56:06] students are often in reunification are not with their parents a variety of challenges that they face so i strongly hope my colleagues will support including this and if it is included i really hope that we can find a way to tell this story with our legislators and really the why behind this from a different lens if they say well we already did some work on this which they did and acknowledge that but there's some reason why we're continuing and here's why so thank you for highlighting those on the slide appreciate that dr robertson i'm asking this question

[00:56:43] primarily for messaging and as support for creating the right message as dr duran is urging us to do if we kept it at 58 students versus 50 students your calculations demonstrate that we would be we kept it at 58 we would be staffing at a lower level in subsequent years yes so the current the 20 to a thousand effectively equates to one to 50. um of course again the differentiation model would mean that those folks are staffed and deployed in different

[00:57:21] ways but even at the higher levels um there would be no fewer instructional positions so for example if a school division only had those level fours the expectation that they would be staffing no fewer instructional positions than they are and i think we all get that um i'm just wondering if an asterisk needs to be provided for anybody who looks at this for public consumption so that they see that it's it's a no-fault change uh you know we're we're not wanting to lose any level of service as a result of the adjustment on the face of it it feels like it's richer investment i'm not

[00:57:59] opposed to that but i think that some clarification might need to be made along the way from a messaging perspective anybody else so is there consensus that we would look to prescribe the language listed as 2021 prescription making that change yes making sure yeah dr robertson and

[00:58:32] miss holton thank you okay wonderful and our last stage here um is looking at the package in its entirety. And one of the board's discussions last month was how we might reflect on these as the entirety of a package, but how we might, again, make sure that we're elevating certain prescriptions where we might see the highest impact in hopes that we can move forward and move the needle as far forward as possible. So with that, we have organized the next three

[00:59:08] slides according to where we have landed on the discussion and where the board might consider elevating certain prescriptions or moving them to the forefront of the discussion. Again, not a prioritization. These are all important items for the standards of quality and for the high-quality education of students. But again, advancing high-impact items and bringing them to the forefront here. The first four being the enhanced at-risk add-on, teacher leader and teacher mentor program, reading specialists, and English learner teachers per the discussion in previous slides. I will note for you here, the numbers that you see on the slide in terms of estimated impact

[00:59:47] have changed since the last time we were all together, and this is based on re-benchmarking numbers, which not to get in front of Mr. Lanz's presentation here during your work session, which you'll hear more about re-benchmarking, but we do have more accurate estimates for what that would look like in the next biennium budget. One item of note on this slide with regards to estimate. It does appear that

the enhanced at-risk add-on, there was a significant drop in state impact or state costs. And that is certainly not a reflection of the change in your policy prescription. It was more a change in the starting line. So because more funding has been put into

[01:00:24] at-risk add-on programs and more funding is available, the difference that we need from a state impact perspective is smaller moving into the next biennium budget. On the next slide, have our principal mentorship work-based learning coordinators assistant principals and elementary school principals a topic for discussion for here may be the work-based learning coordinator item which we do have it estimated still based on the state level positions or state-based positions at 1.2 million and lastly on the last slide is the k-3 class size reduction proposal specialized

[01:01:02] student support personnel and school counselors and again these items while we we know are still of utmost importance the k-3 class size reduction was a transition from a program being in the budget to the standards of quality to make sure that that is an institutionalized program but that still is in effect and we have seen some progress in terms of specialized student support personnel and school counselors in terms of ratios so again bringing to the forefront some of those other action areas and area items that you would really like to see promoted in the upcoming general

[01:01:34] Assembly Sessions. And we will pause there with that one. I know that was a large topic of discussion for the Board, so I will be happy to answer any questions and let you reflect on that list as we have it ordered here and make any adjustments as you all see fit.

[01:01:52] Trustee Nancy Ingram: Yes, ma'am. Trustee Nancy Ingram: So just an observation and things that I've been thinking about. I appreciate the framing, Dr. Sayle, of our wanting to identify in this prescription those items we we believe are going to have the greatest impact or have impact on our students and their learning.

[01:02:15] So I really appreciate that frame. Human nature though, I think will be to see whatever order as priorities. And so I don't know how we do that, how we demonstrate or present this in a way that makes clear the frame without necessarily suggesting, And maybe we end up wanting to suggest some priority order.

[01:02:42] The only other comment that I will make is thinking about knowing that human nature may be to see any list as prioritized list. The thought about assistant principals versus principal, or and principals, I won't say versus, but this idea of elementary school principals, reaffirming the 2016 recommendation that every elementary school should have a principal alongside the belief that assistant principals are also important at the full-time level for four.

[01:03:21] So just kind of thinking about, you know, human nature wanting to prioritize, but also thinking about the value of having, building leadership represented in a principal in every elementary school.

[01:03:37] So two observations that I will make. - No answers, just observations. anybody else with observations or perhaps more happily solutions so just a point of clarification again the help me to understand that the rank the ranking of what's the intent of how this is presented is it presented to legislators like these are the top ones on this page what what is the impact of what we're

[01:04:14] asked about this I'm just trying to I'll a clarification more than take a first First, crack at that and then let Ms. Boye add to it. There are many steps in the General Assembly's budget process, and it starts with agencies making recommendations to the governor, and we call it colloquially the DPB system.

[01:04:37] We put those in in terms of what we think the governor should fund in numerical order, and unlike his legislative proposals, the budget proposals are publicly available. So the Department of Ed is going to rank your priorities either way, and that's how it goes into the governor for his consideration.

[01:05:00] Then the governor releases a budget with the items that he would have in, and then it goes to the General Assembly. Now in terms of more technically how your prescriptions go to the General Assembly, there are a couple different ways that that can be done, and there's been great debate amongst many of us on how to do that.

[01:05:17] But one way is for legislators to carry the standards of quality in a bill, and then it's debated that way in committee, and that was a tactic that we attempted two sessions ago, I suppose. And then another is that you communicate it by letter to the General Assembly. But in terms of more tactically how it gets in, things that are not in the governor's budget that are high dollar items tactically rarely get in, not to say that there aren't major adjustments by the General Assembly. And so for us, at least from my perspective, when I put things in, I put it in

[01:05:57] based on a belief of what I think your priorities are. But if that was more definitive, we can order it that way. But Holly, do you want to talk more about the more technical prescription side of it? Yeah, I mean, I think when it comes to sending your formal prescriptions via a letter to the governor and general assembly, we have, you know, it's a long form letter and we can provide lots of narrative and context to that and frame it any way that you desire.

[01:06:21] So if it were the will of the board to say, you know, we have a subset of four, for example, that are you know where we want to see the focus this year understanding them in a broader context we could simply bring four to the to the forefront there and we could figure out how to reflect that in the practical system that dr lane has shared a bit about and to communicate that more broadly leaving all others equal but just bringing four to the forefront as an example or we could provide a rank order you know one one through 15 here's how we would prioritize and as you have money just keep working your way down the list. So in that sense, I think there's a little bit of

[01:06:58] flexibility based on the desire of the board and how you want to frame that, how far you want to go in that prioritization, whether it's just tier one and tier two or a more nuanced ranking of something. Thank you for that explanation. I would suggest to my colleagues that we think about a tier one, tier two, tier three, rather than literal ranking one, two, three, four, five, that gets I mean, we could do that, but I think we're going to have a lot of conversation.

[01:07:26] So I don't know, Mr. President, how we do that, but that's my suggestion. I don't know how my colleagues feel about that. But given the description that we just heard, I feel that might be a better approach to have tiers of things that we're trying to move forward. But I welcome other thoughts.

[01:07:42] Well, if I heard what Dr. Lane said, though, leaving it absent, you're going to do it based on your interpretation. So I hope that we find some way as colleagues to give more guidance or at least more clarity for that interpretation. Dr. Mann?

[01:07:58] In the observation bucket, it's interesting because I think as I've served, I've come to appreciate that a fair bit of education policy gets articulated in the legislature and the board is responsible for taking in those charges and making certain that it becomes a part of regulation and such.

[01:08:27] And it would seem that it would be important for a board if it has such limited opportunities to articulate and influence and shape what it hopes would happen from an education policy perspective, that we would find a way to, in fact, be explicit about what we want to make certain is understood with respect to priorities that we have, with the understanding that, of course, the standards of quality will always represent a comprehensive point of view

[01:09:04] of what's important to ensure that children have access to a quality education. So I think it's incumbent upon us, given that there is so few opportunities, in my observation, I could be a little bit off on that, but to impact policy in a significant way.

[01:09:28] Yeah, Ms. Holton. Well, I'm going to go back to, I think, what, well, somebody, now I can't remember who said before, but I just think it would take too much time.

[01:09:45] Francisco, I think it was you. It would take a lot of time to get us to a point of agreement on priority, and I think at this late date, it's not useful, and following up on what Dr. Mann just said, you know, the standards are the standards.

[01:10:00] This is what we think is necessary for minimally adequate education, and maybe we shouldn't try, at least in the document, to choose between our children, so to speak. There may be other opportunities for engagement with legislators and or folks at DPB to, you know, discuss how various particular priorities fit in to the overall picture.

[01:10:29] and there may be some that get prioritized because they're more politically doable than others. But we shouldn't be taking those factors into account in terms of establishing what the standards are. So for what it's worth, I suggest that, I mean, we could even say at the beginning, in no particular order our recommendations are or something like that.

[01:10:56] Mainly, I just think it's too hopeless to try to decide priorities. i don't know how i would do it for myself among some of these much less how we would reach agreement amongst us thank you getting back to i'm sorry dr duran go ahead i was just going to follow up with what you said and but my second thought was about how do we put some into tears because towards the end of the presentation the last slide maybe it was the last slide and the last two there were some items there that had had some significant impact and some work in progress has been made as well as the um principal and elementary principal and assistant principal those pieces

[01:11:33] which in my mind aren't as much of a priority as the tier as some of the others so i mean i could see it both ways i agree what you just said overall these are the standards but at the end of the day the reality is that i think our legislators and even if i heard you correct dr langrick if i'm wrong you do have to prioritize in some way some of these you know right i mean there was a bill you said that a legislator did carry about the full soqs but i think the reality is there may be times and correct me if i'm wrong where there might need to be an understanding of what was more of a priority or not correct me if i'm not if that's not important but i feel like it is

[01:12:08] potentially one and absence of saying at least some tears then i just wonder what interpretation is without that guidance from us i think you know i've been uh one of the people who has been going going to the legislature the last couple years since the board prescribed SOQs.

[01:12:29] And we always get asked, you know, what's the priority? And the answer has been, you know, we don't pick among our kids, they're all favorites. That has not been a particularly successful approach to

this problem, you know, as a practical matter. And although there is a certain amount of value, I think, to being ideologically pure on this and saying these are the standards, I'm not sure it has yielded the results that we want.

[01:12:55] And, you know, I would personally support Francisco's concept of going tiers. And frankly, you could almost look at those items on slide 15 as a first tier. The items on 16, you know, I'm not sure I'd rank order them quite this way, but as a second tier.

[01:13:18] And then, you know, the ones on 17, you know, you have one with no state impact. and frankly, the student support personnel is not really an SOQ item, you know, that would be, if you will, those would be the third tier. I would also, you know, like to just mention to Dr. Mann's point or observation that, you know, we have been largely tasked over the years with

[01:13:51] implementation of legislatively determined policy. You know, one of the express goals of the board, five years ago, when we decided to embark upon the road of doing SOQs again for the first time in two decades, was to begin to act as a policy body and therefore hopefully obviating the need and perhaps the desire of the legislature to tinker around the edges of the system all the time and move the board back into a policy formulation role, which I think is the constitutional

[01:14:29] contemplation and the legislature back into a check on that role as opposed to the legislature being the policy body and us being really the implementation of that policy. And, you know, we won't know for a long time whether the board's efforts in that regard will be successful, but I am hopeful that the more thoughtful we are and the more, you know, we are able to put forth sane policies and become recognized as a body that is dealing with policy as opposed to the

[01:15:04] regulatory aspect, that we will begin to see a shift back to where the balance was, you know, when the modern-day Virginia Constitution was first put into effect. Will that happen during my tenure? I doubt it. You know, the institutions are slow to change. But, you know, if we continue down a path of thoughtful consideration of the important policy issues that guide the education of our kids, I think over time we'll get it back. Will we stop individuals from tinkering around the edges every time a constituent says something, a bill gets introduced? No, that won't happen.

[01:15:41] But as to the bigger stuff, how important is having a principal in every school? How important is having in poor divisions experienced teachers teaching those kids? I think on the bigger issues we're going to make progress and i think you already see that by the slow roll of favorable comments in the press and frankly in the political sphere you know moving our way do we have a majority yet no but i think we're making progress a very slow roll down the hill at this point so you know i appreciate that observation but i think that observation is one of those things that

[01:16:17] continues to motivate me and i hope the board to push policy that makes sense for educational outcome through with the idea it will all come back to us. But that was a long way of saying, you know, I would tend toward Francisco on this.

[01:16:33] You know, as a matter of sort of consistency, I wonder why we have, and this is a small point, you know, a cost associated with work-based learning coordinators, if in fact it's already paid for, if you will, through Perkins funds.

[01:16:49] It seems to me to be consistent with the other places where we say no additional state impact. This ought to be a no additional state impact item. Mr. President, yes, I did have that observation, but I did

want to clarify the spirit of my comment was really in favor.

[01:17:07] If you are a policy, if you are endeavoring to impact policy, you have to be prepared to engage in the act of sort of what is important? How are we going to go at making certain that the things we care about have a chance of being uh uptaken right so my observation was really in that vein of supporting the importance of acting in that way and not so much you know my observation of just kind of the broader sense of what i've come to understand it's it's interesting i have people approach me

[01:17:46] sometimes and and their sense of what it means to be on the state board of education is quite different from really what and how the board tends to its authority if you will right um so i i very much support struggling through trying to figure out a way of giving the hard work that's gone into articulating soqs and really trying to ensure that they have a they have a chance to continue to sort of be invested in, that's sort of my desire.

[01:18:23] No, no, I appreciate that. I'm sorry if I used your observation inappropriately to sort of tee off on one of my favorite topics, which is, you know, what we should be doing and, you know, what they ought to be doing. And so perhaps I shouldn't have used yours to be that springboard, but I don't think it can be said enough about, you know, where we're going, you know, As the board membership changes over, we've had turnover since '17, and sometimes I feel the need to keep resetting it to make sure everybody on the board is on the same page.

[01:19:02] Dr. Robertson. I don't want my comments to be taken to suggest anything less than we have, through this complete set of prescriptions, we are taking a bold step, and we're on the eve of taking a bold step too i i aspire to want to do what francisco is suggesting but i i think right now as a practical matter as miss holton was questioning do we have the time to do that in

[01:19:38] a thoughtful manner even if we selected tiers do we have time to do that thoughtfully on the eve of the of the decision making my fear is that if we did push forward to establish priorities and maybe we're not suggesting that we're going to do it by tomorrow but if we do rush that action we're going to be picking among children as miss holton was suggesting and from a budget maker's perspective from the legislative perspective we may be letting them off the hook

[01:20:15] by picking what we perceive to be most important and that's where all the political capital gets expended. We're saying that all of these are important to us. I don't feel comfortable establishing priorities on the eve of the decision making. Dr. Mann. And I'm wondering about sort of a both-and approach because I guess as I listen to Ms. Coy talk about the way things are advanced as the SOQs go forward and how that can be presented versus the opportunity that Dr.

[01:20:50] Lane has in affecting recommendations through his own channel that I don't see them as needing to be either or. I support a holistic way of framing and talking about these as they go forth. But I also think that doesn't have to negate our ability to clearly articulate in concert with the department has an opportunity to influence a point of view there.

[01:21:16] and mr president i i wanted to also suggest that as a process perspective from a process perspective if we wanted to establish priorities as part of this process in the future maybe there's a way this information can be presented to us so that we can do a prioritization as we're going through the discussion as opposed to again on the eve of conversation i don't know what that looks like

[01:21:42] but i'd be willing to see what that looked like i'm sorry miss halton uh so maybe following up on dr mann's suggestion that if we present a holistic all of these recommendations not priorities within them but then you know if dr lane has some sense from our discussions about what priorities are he can share them more informally you mr president can share them more informally with legislators

[01:22:19] as needed and we can continue that conversation we don't have to do all that right now because even though the governor the dpd process may be uh quickly proceeding the legislature isn't here until january right and so um and and some of that party's discussion you know it may be important to hear from the field and they the the the coalition of of education groups that weighs in at the general assembly may have views that help influence our views so all of that said and even your

[01:22:54] suggestions uh uh uh dan that you know maybe slide 15 is the first tier and slide 16 is the second tier i hear it but i'm like well wait a minute i feel pretty important strongly about the school counselor piece. And I could make a case, having done finally my reading assignment from you of the Chenoweth book, I could make a case that supporting principal mentorship and more principals is the most important thing. So anyway, I'm just being contrary.

[01:23:32] We certainly appreciate that, and we're sorry for the technical difficulty on your line. What did you just say? Okay, anybody else? Where does that leave us in terms of consensus? Are we going to try today, tomorrow, sometime prior to the session? I mean, it's not just, you know, VDOE.

[01:24:00] The secretary is going to make recommendations in to the governor's budget, and I'm sure that there, you know, some guidance from us would be appreciated, but if we choose not to give it, that's okay. But I will say that near and dear to my heart is the idea of providing in poor jurisdictions more money to provide more experienced teachers. And if push came to shove and somebody said, if you get one thing on this list, honestly, that would be mine. There is

[01:24:38] research that backs that up. It's clear that we have failed in that regard. That is keeping that resource, you know, comparable for children from lower socioeconomics. And if I were to make a pitch, you know, I will say that I am, I think I've been very good in both public and private conversation, not going past where the board has sort of authorized me to go. And so I don't, you know, sort of wink and nod and say, yeah, this is the one we want. But if there were some

[01:25:11] consensus that we could at least talk about really the standard that started all this, the reallocation piece. It would be appreciated by me as I go talk to legislators and to the secretary and to James about where the board is. Is there any kind of consensus around that? And if not, that's okay. I mean, I'm not pushing this to, gee, it's got to be done, but it would be helpful because i do believe that forms sort of the first you know support for where we're going

[01:25:48] if i may chime in and redeem myself yes if i had to choose one i would choose with you okay i would choose the same right okay choosing rather than rank them all why don't we just say as a board we have placed a significant prior not priority but we an emphasis on this as we believe it will have the most significant benefit to our children. Is that fair? You know, don't let me go past where you guys are comfortable. I just -- I think, President Gecker, I think that is consistent, actually, with our conversations. While we have not had, I think, perhaps as deep a set of

[01:26:28] conversations around that particular item as we had in 2019 and other years, I think our focus has been on what else, not saying that we are done with this, put it aside, we're complete, but what else

might there be? So I think that it's a fair path to say that if we were to identify one, this remains a central concern for us as a board.

[01:26:57] All right. I think that's the way we'll do this then for now. On the issue of the Perkins plan, I think we have some further information from the superintendent. Thanks, and because I know Tom is in the back of the room, and so he doesn't totally freak out, I just want to remind the audience that even though it's not on the slides, the support cap is still in the prescriptions, and that's -- I would tell you that from the field standpoint, at least from the superintendent standpoint, that actually would be their number

[01:27:30] one priority, and I just don't want that to be ignored as the board thinks through this. On the Perkins plan, I spent some time reading it. I'm not speaking on behalf of the OAG 'cause I know you asked her to look at it, but in my rereading of it, I would actually state that I'm not sure that the Perkins plan is specific enough to mandate that work-based learning is how that funding is used.

[01:27:55] It lays out the priorities of the reserve fund, but it doesn't go as far as to say that it will fund work-based learning coordinators. So you have really two options. One would be to make Perkins more specific it's the board's goal to always use federal funding for that or you can keep it in the soq i would say though mr gecker i disagree a little bit with saying that it has no state cost because i don't think you can prescribe how federal funds are used in the soq uh if you want this to be paid

[01:28:25] for from a state standpoint it would have to be in the standards of quality follow-up question he said we could make it more prescriptive now or the next time it came up would we revise it you can revise your program at any time but it would require not only our approval but federal government Yeah, so we did a four-year plan, and I will speak for the AG since I got an email from Ruth Williams. Also, a work-based learning coordinator apparently doesn't appear in the

[01:28:58] Perkins plan. So, you know, it was a generalized allocation of money back to the state as opposed to a commitment to fund the work-based learning coordinators. Are there any more thoughts on that, or you want to wait till tomorrow to retackle it to, you know, I think it's an important component, frankly, of the system. You know, we were tasked a number of years ago with Portugal, Virginia graduate, and we did that work. And part of it is to provide not just

[01:29:35] the pure academic course, but also the technical education piece of this. And this is part of that process. Dr. Mann. So was it always clear that the 1.2 million that was in here was tied to Perkins, or were we thinking that because Perkins exists, that's another way to ensure that there's support for this, because then it just becomes Perkins plus $1.2 million?

[01:30:01] Yeah, thank you. It's probably a good history reminder. The board's initial thought was that this would be funded in the standards of quality and thus paid for by the state. Once we got into this and saw that maybe that all of the SOQs weren't going to get funded for some time, and when we had this opportunity to add a new type of fund to the Perkins Plan, in May of 2020, the board decided to add that reserve fund. And in our discussions, even though it's not detailed as specifically in the plan as I just stated, the board made it clear

[01:30:39] they were really setting up that reserve fund with the intent of it to be to fund work-based learning coordinators. So the department went forward and did that. But to Mr. Gecker's point, that means that should you know future departments of ed future boards of ed want to change that it it would not take

more than just a quick decision but um the the intent of when we put it into the soq the board put it into the soq was for it to be state funded the president yes sir given the the information we just heard i would change what i was saying earlier i would support them leaving

[01:31:18] it in soq soq i know we may not be doing tears but if we were doing tears i would suggest that be in a second tier i agree with dr roberson though if we're asked to do this overnight i wouldn't support doing a tear right now overnight but if there's a possibility to engage in some kind of activity or discussion that we could have tears prior to the prior to the session and i would think we i would suggest that we would do that i think that would be beneficial i don't know if that's what the time maybe i guess that's a question what would be the time that we would need to have that it doesn't does it have to be tomorrow we acted or can we act on

[01:31:53] tomorrow and then have that as a follow-up you're asking about priorities yes sir well to be clear we've already submitted the priorities for this year so there's no pressure on time from our standpoint i think dr duran the point is though that before we begin talking to legislators it would be good to have it and i think we have time to accomplish that that's my suggestion yeah i I think that's fine, unless anybody's got contrary views there.

[01:32:23] And I think we have a suggestion now that we leave the work-based coordinators in the SOQs. Is there anybody who's got a contrary thought or supporting that, or is that the consensus of the board now? I take the nodding of heads as that is the consensus of the board now.

[01:32:44] Okay. Well, thank you all very much, and that's what we're going to do. I think that covers it. It does, indeed. Thanks for the clarity of the presentation. Oh, well, I'm glad it was helpful, and we will see you tomorrow to dot I's and cross T's on this thing.

[01:33:02] Thank you both. Appreciate it. Thank you. Okay, Dr. Hollins.

[01:33:19] I'm going to sit down today, guys. Good afternoon. Thank you so much, President Gecker. It's a pleasure to be with you all this afternoon on a topic that is near and dear to my heart. We're going to conduct an overview of special education staffing this afternoon, so I hope you're ready to get into the weeds with me.

[01:33:35] Let's talk a little bit about the background for special education staffing. As many of you are aware, given your own personal expertise in school management and division-level leadership, staffing is a really complex area of support. And what I'm going to do is take you on kind of a 360 version of what this looks like, particularly for special education.

[01:33:56] Provide a little bit of information regarding the background of where our guardrails come from with special education staffing, as well as kind of bringing you up to speed with the current state of events. Spend a little bit of time, if you'll allow me, to talk a little bit about some of the relevant factors we're faced with in this area, as well as areas for your consideration moving forward.

[01:34:16] I've also worked diligently with not only staff here at the department, but with our partners out in the field, talking about this issue and where we can go next, particularly with some of the recent information we have from the Joint Legislative Audit Review Commission studies of both the DOE agency as well as K-12 special education.

[01:34:32] And I'm also really happy to talk about the fact that we have not waited on any of this. This is an area of priority for the department for really the last decade, if not more. And I'm happy to report since I've come back to the department, we've really kind of taken more of a leadership role in identifying opportunities that are out there for us to provide more support and context, particularly to the Commonwealth.

[01:34:56] And so one, just to kind of tee us up, special education staffing is really seen in three main areas of documentation for the Board of Education's consideration. The first is in the standards of quality, which establishes language around instructional staffing ratios for school divisions.

[01:35:13] Those ratios are specific to grade disciplines and also provides authority to the board to set specific ratios for students with disabilities and their regulations. And I will tell you, that's probably the most detailed area of special education staffing is within your regulations governing special education programs for children in Virginia.

[01:35:31] We also have language within the standards of accreditation that discuss the standard loads for teachers, as well as how those would apply to integrated classrooms. As you can imagine, special education is a really complex program and looks different for each of our students and each of our schools.

[01:35:46] AND SO HOW WE APPROACH IT REALLY SHOULD BE SOMETHING THAT IS DYNAMIC AND IN CONSIDERATION OF MULTIPLE FACTORS, PARTICULARLY AS IT RELATES TO THE SUCCESS AND SUPPORT OF OUR STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES. AS I MENTIONED, THE STATE SPECIAL EDUCATION REGULATIONS REALLY DO THE DEPTH OF THE WORK AROUND STAFFING AND I WANT TO TAKE YOU THROUGH JUST A COUPLE OF PIECES THAT I THINK ARE REALLY HELPFUL FOR YOU TO CONSIDER.

[01:36:07] THE FIRST IS PERSONNEL ASSIGNMENT AND THAT IS THE FACT THAT WHEN WE'RE TALKING ABOUT SPECIAL EDUCATION STAFFING, WE REALLY CAN'T HAVE THAT CONVERSATION UNLESS WE KNOW ABOUT special education licensure requirements and the fact that for many of our teachers they require specialized licenses in order to do the work that they do and so you can imagine this is where the inception point was for the department to provide a lot of support particularly to our institutes of higher education to support but it oftentimes stand up those preparation programs particularly for some of our more complex disabilities such as sensory disabilities of students who are deaf blind students blind or visual impairments and students who are deaf and hard of hearing. Within the regulations, we also provide information on

[01:36:46] caseload maximums. A special education caseload is a group of students that a special education teacher is assigned and serves as caseload manager for. You're probably thinking about what this looks like in the real world, and that is a teacher who has the knowledge, expertise, and supports around an individual student and serves as a point of contact and a lead for things like development of their individualized education plan, collection of data and reports relate to their progress reports and really serves as a link for that student and their family back to their neighborhood school where they're being served.

[01:37:19] So this is an incredibly small type so that you will not be able to read, and I can really tell you whatever I'd like to tell you this afternoon. These two tables are in the back of the special education regulations, and they really serve as pretty much the closest thing we have to a quick reference cheat sheet for special education staffing.

[01:37:36] As I mentioned, in addition to the SOQ and the special ed regulations, we provide two two methods for calculating minimum SPED staffing requirements. And so you'll see in this table there is a demarcation for students who are level one and level two. And level one are students that receive special education services less than 50% of their day.

[01:37:56] So you can think about a student who may have a speech language impairment and receives a speech language therapy with a speech language pathologist for a couple of pullout sessions over the week. You may think of a student with dyslexia who receives an additional bolster of support in addition to their direct reading instruction block.

[01:38:13] Those students are level one. They spend the majority of their time in general education. Students in level two receive 50% or more of their day in special education instruction. And as you can imagine, these are for students who have more significant disabilities.

[01:38:29] Some of us might refer to them as more self-contained settings where they may spend the majority of their day with a special education teacher who is the primary designer and designee of their instruction throughout the day. We also have two methods to calculate. This first table shows you what that method of calculation for maximum caseload would look like if we are serving those two groups of students separately.

[01:38:51] So back in the day when I was in the classroom, I served as a self-contained teacher. So I had all level two students for the majority of my day. And so my caseload maximums were determined off of what you see here. A colleague of mine provided the in-class support. was a resource special education teacher and so she spent the majority of her day and her caseload were students level one so there's a demarcation there for what our caseloads look like and you can imagine mine was smaller than hers right and that seems to make sense to you when you look at this the second table is a method assuming that students are receiving both level one and level two services together so this is a classroom that at times may be serving level one and level two

[01:39:30] students together perhaps around a specialized reading program but then has students that return to the general education setting for other content areas, while some students may remain with that teacher through the day. So you can imagine this is a model that we see more prevalent in elementary education, for example.

[01:39:45] And so it really gives you these two kind of different calculators, if you will, dependent upon the needs of the students that we're serving. And you see quite clearly there is consideration for additional support with staff like paraprofessionals. As you can imagine, many of our students require that additional level of support, and so that's taken into consideration when we make these calculations.

[01:40:05] One of the relevant factors for us when we talk about staffing, no doubt has to be funding. The Board of Education regulations govern those minimum staffing requirements, but those also set the base level for how we fund students. And so it really is a cyclical process.

[01:40:21] School divisions report to us on the number of students they have, the level of which they're served. That data is inputted and then out pops their allocation for funding to support X number of positions given the number of students they have. That is called the Standards of Quality Funding Allocation. That is based on JLARC methodology that is established in the late 1980s.

[01:40:40] SOQ funding provides for the state share of salary, fringe benefits, and support costs on instructional positions based on the staffing standards and special education that we received direct data from the December 1 data collection. You guys remember that's our head count of students with disabilities in the commonwealth, who they are, where they are, how they're being served.

[01:40:59] The second portion of that funding is bolstered by federal funding. The Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, or IDEA, allocates funding directly to the state, which flows through DOE to individual allocations to school divisions.

[01:41:15] You'll grant me a little bit of license here to remind you that the IDEA has yet to be fully funded. And so when we talk about the portion of federal state set aside for support of students with disabilities, it's a reminder that that legislation required the federal government to commit 40% of funding.

[01:41:31] The current level of funding, which has been stable over the last two decades, is 14.7%. So you can imagine there's a pretty big gap there when we talk about support to bolster appropriate staffing levels that really has fallen incumbent on the state. And I would make the argument even more on locality-based funding.

[01:41:49] And so you can imagine that there is, in fact, a disparate impact on localities on special education funding. For some of our smaller divisions, their ability to make up that cost alongside with a smaller portion of IDEA based on the smaller number of students they serve can be a real challenge for them on top of some of the issues we've talked about quite comprehensively around recruitment and retention.

[01:42:10] Speaking of recruitment and retention, data collection is also another relevant factor that we need to consider. As you no doubt remember from our conversations around the JLARC studies, the lack of verifiable and longitudinal data that is rich in detail around educational positions is something that the department is taking steps forward to ameliorate, and so we're really excited.

[01:42:30] about the upcoming collection for the positions and exits data collection, which is our new collection that debuted this year. That data is rolling in as we speak and should be in our hands by December for year one. And we're really thinking that that will give us a great comprehensive picture of what the needs of school divisions are.

[01:42:48] Now don't get me wrong, that's probably not going to tell us a different story from what we already know, and that is that our divisions are struggling. They're struggling to maintain those positions, they're struggling to maintain fully licensed individuals in those positions, they're struggling to retain them over time. When we talk about those struggles, we really focus on recruitment and retention. And something I talk about quite frequently with my team members is that this is nothing new for us in special education. We have been the lucky recipients of the number one critical shortage area for a number of years now. And so this is something that myself, as well as my predecessors, has spent a lot of time, a lot of resources on seeking to

[01:43:24] address. And it's painful to say that I don't think we've seen the growth and development we would assume that we would see given some of those resources the department significantly puts aside a fair portion of our state set-aside to prop up higher education programs and personnel prep around the state as you can imagine some of our programs that we desperately need around sensory disabilities

around more intensive support needs students are the first to get cut when those numbers are low in higher education so we work very closely with our colleagues and teacher education licensure to ensure that we have the ability and the access point for teachers and student teachers going into the field to be licensed and able to

[01:44:03] serve all of our students in the most successful way possible we also know that this is a continuing area of focus from your advisory board the state special education advisory committee continues to see this as their number one priority i was with them a number of weeks ago and this was the number one topic of their discussion and particularly as we this year as we as we always do right during the beginning of school field inquiries and requests from around the state how can you help us recruit and retain how can we find more teachers what are some strategies other folks are using it really continues to be a call but i will say this year is the first year i have received calls from school divisions that i've never heard from previously it's starting to hit some of

[01:44:41] our highest performers and our highest success rates for recruitment and retention and so this need particularly in the area of special education continues to grow and become a real issue that i think is is well deserving of your attention and so i'm really excited that you all are kind of turning your attention to this in a way that I think will be helpful. I mentioned JLARC. This is an area of the study when it was first, when the study resolution was first received that we were really excited to see a big focus on. I will share with you that in my personal opinion that the report really didn't give us as much robust information as we were hoping for. I think it hit

[01:45:18] on some of the really high interest areas talking about the role of special education and general education talking about the role of administrator development about the role of our general education teacher counterparts. However, I think Dr. Lane was really well poised to respond and really clarifying that this continues to be a huge area of urgency for us. We continue to work to help the field identify best practices and at times help to put into place projects or demonstrations that can really staunch the flow from these programs, right? How can we help to support school divisions in lieu of a more comprehensive reform around large

[01:45:54] scale teacher recruitment and retention that's not just special education. I mentioned coming to you. One of the things that we definitely want to do is to know that we're working on this. We continue to support those institutes of higher education with a focus on personnel prep.

[01:46:10] One thing that I have done in coming to the department is really asking some tough questions. For a number of years, we financed programs and really haven't seen a good output from that. So what can we do to talk about diversifying the funding we're currently using? How can we redirect that and perhaps think about having state-level area, particularly with the impact of virtual education in higher ed?

[01:46:31] How can we maybe not have so many programs, but maybe condense it to a number that students can still have access to, and then direct funding directly to local school divisions to help to support them? So that's something that we continue to kind of take a critical lens to, to make sure that all the funds we're using even if we've been doing it what is it giving us what are we seeing as far as the output and product for all of that support partnerships across our agency to support robust data collection i mentioned the position and exits collection i think that's going to provide some really great data for us in special education to examine working with our colleagues and teacher and licensure on a strategic plan that really just isn't about special education it's really about

[01:47:10] addressing recruitment and retention overall and i'm even more excited to say that we have been on the cusp of states around the nation and seeking outside and external support for this initiative we were recently awarded with a grant from the u.s department of education focused on personnel development and this grant i think will play a really important role for us as we move forward particularly in seeing how we can leverage what we know to be best practice what we know to work with school divisions and thinking about how we can grow that support we have a really complex set of interventions that we house within virginia tiered systems of support and we think that that

[01:47:46] provides a unique scaffold for some of our work around recruitment and retention if we know that workplace conditions are are an area of challenge for teachers how can we help them to have the skills and supports necessary to to make learning environments more successful more inclusive and really make sure that not only are they serving students in a more robust way but how can they come to the table excited about what that job looks like every day and how can we build those supports around them because it's not just about one person it's really about a school community and particularly around innovative approaches to support special education personnel you know this is a field that for me personally has been part of my professional development my

[01:48:25] phd dissertation research was on coaching and support for teachers so how can we leverage what we know to be true in research to really continue to move forward here in virginia and be known as a national leader in developing effective recruitment and retention strategies particularly for our special education teachers a couple of areas for you to consider as we really continue along our work plan but obviously having you to having you to clarify support areas of priority things that you see and being able to talk about the work the department is already doing we've had a really great relationship with our colleagues at the u.s department of education around their

[01:49:02] recruitment efforts around attract prepare retain effective personnel for all and so how are we thinking about leveraging these opportunities across all of the positions within schools that support our students, right? It's really talking about the shift from special education to general education, right? If we're talking about good quality core instruction and interventions and supports for all students, how can that maybe help us to rethink some of the area of specialized support we've had for students with disabilities? Our work around providing training and technical assistance to school divisions, I'm exceptionally pleased about the work that we've done over the last number of years with our journey into teaching program

[01:49:38] this is a grant program we've worked with school divisions in region one in region eight most recently with petersburg city public schools for the first time this year had a fully staffed special education teacher cadre through our support we've been able to support provision licensed staff in petersburg city to become fully licensed and also to remain with their school division based on that support that is a huge victory for a school division we know has struggled and they're not the only one how can we replicate that work how can we take this project by project approach and really serve to make it more comprehensive and sustainable talking about innovative staffing models um one thing you'll hear from me today is that more might not be the

[01:50:16] answer maybe different is the answer and thinking about how we can utilize and leverage other state examples consideration of severity of need of our students kind of this idea of a workload analysis model as opposed to a head count caseload so i can have two students with autism in my

classroom and you can imagine the differences that they would have and the need and the amount of support that they would be provided in order to be successful in an educational environment.

[01:50:41] How can we build a model that's dynamic and flexible enough to truly meet the needs of our students, but also to truly identify the workload on our teachers? And more importantly, I would offer for you to, you know, take into consideration the fact that one of the roles that I see is really important is serving as an advisor to the department leadership and also to the board and thinking about how can we adapt our approach? How can we shift our thinking instead of doing the same thing in another way, but really shift it to look at the problem from a whole different perspective? And I mentioned the shift of special ed to general ed. You see some of that in what

[01:51:19] we're seeing in legislation, right? How can we help general ed teachers to understand more of their role in the IEP team? How can we help general education teachers to be able to provide specialized standardized instruction that I would make an argument benefits not only students with disabilities but perhaps other students in the classroom that may or may not be identified.

[01:51:36] How can we shift from more adults to more time? Because we know that more time with quality instruction truly benefits our students. It's not about having more people in the classroom necessarily. It's about having the time in the classroom well spent and well quality when we talk about the approach to instructional design and delivery.

[01:51:54] How can we move from generalist to specialist? We've had a lot of conversations in the recent years around support for students with dyslexia and students with specific learning disabilities. We've seen the payoff of that work. How can we shift into supporting teachers to develop a specialized portfolio of services and skills that they can apply within a school community?

[01:52:12] We've talked about the shift from deterrence to prevention. The work that we do up front in supporting our students in behavior development, social emotional learning, trauma-informed care. How can we wrap that network of support around kiddos so that they enter into school being supported, being successful, and perhaps not getting to the point of identification of a disability, because all their needs are being met in kind of that tier one structure of a well-rounded educational environment?

[01:52:39] How can we talk about scheduling for schools, which I think is probably the least interesting topic but the most important with how we build a school day for our kids? And then how do we go from managing compliance to really managing practice, you know, helping to vest our educators with the supports and skills they need not only to do good work in the classrooms, but to be supported by administrators who truly understand the needs of the profession and what that support would look like.

[01:53:04] And so I'll pause there. I hope that's kind of a quick 36,000 view, if you will. We talk about special education staffing. I'm happy to entertain any comments, but to also answer any questions you might have, as well as inquiries further related to this topic. Dr. Wilson.

[01:53:20] Dr. Hollins, thanks for the overview. helpful. On slide 11, you identify external support to particular grants. If you could talk a little bit about, so as I heard you describe them, it sounded as if it perhaps begins, the focus begins at the DOE level and then fans out into the field, or is it vice versa? Help me understand kind of how those grant funds will help in the field.

[01:53:50] Happy to. The first grant that I mentioned, which is the personnel development grant, is really aimed at the department structure for now. So our work will ascertain whether coaching and technical

assistance at the teacher level paired with alignment of our retention efforts is really going to pay off, right? So put your money where your mouth is.

[01:54:06] If we're working with our VTSS school divisions and inputting best practice around teacher recruitment and retention, are we able to show that we can be successful? So that's really about us intervening with school divisions that are already closely partnering with us. The second grant, which is a technical assistance and a moderate amount of staff support from the University of Florida Cedar Center is really around thinking about how can we get help out to school divisions now?

[01:54:30] For example, this grant has allowed us to already seek out and provide an opportunity for our special education directors to join us over the next two months in a facilitated discussion about their needs and really hoping to link them up, not only to what's working around the country, but then to help develop a work plan for us at the state level that will inform our strategic plan around recruitment and retention.

[01:54:50] is really ta for the state level to kind of get working but this will be done hand in hand with our local stakeholders i mentioned the calls we have scheduled both at the end of october beginning november for our special education directors but i'll also be joining the virginia council for administrators and special education at their fall conference tomorrow and this is going to be the hot topic for our conversation where we will allow some breakout discussions and we have some great work that's happening i mentioned petersburg montgomery county campbell county that have grown some really successful programs we want folks to hear and have discussions about how they can support each other not just now but particularly in this era of covet and i would

[01:55:27] argue post-pandemic impact which we can already see rolling towards us and so this is something that while we are really engaged around receiving support we're also not waiting for other folks to help us with this work anybody else no thank you so much for the presentation dr harlins oh i'm sorry miss holton forgetting to look at the screen i just mainly wanted to chime in to say thank you thank you dr hollins for sharing that good news from petersburg and anything you can do to help us learn what worked for them that others might do too or what we as a board can do to more

[01:56:04] facilitate what's worked there we'd love to know but congratulations on that good and important work that's really a major accomplishment thank you so much secretary holton the praise really belongs to Petersburg who was game to do this work with us and to their amazing special education director and the teachers themselves who put in a lot of work with a little bit of support from us to do something that they're really passionate about. It was truly our pleasure.

[01:56:28] Okay. Thank you so much. And I guess as a committee, we stand adjourned.

[01:56:37] We begin the board's work session in 10 minutes. I think everybody's back. We're going to begin the

[02:07:18] work session of the Virginia Board of Education. I'd like to welcome everybody. in particular our first guest dr matthew steinberg and dr seth hunter who have agreed to talk to us about teacher evaluation reform we are very grateful for your presence here and for the work you guys are doing uh i don't know if you need more of an intro than that or if you can launch into this but uh it's time yeah dr mr uh gecker thank you thanks to the board for the invitation dr james lane for his work over the last year and emily webb for helping to coordinate

[02:07:52] this conversation today so we'll start with just a brief introduction of who we are and our backgrounds and then we'll we'll jump right into a background on evaluation reform what we know from the evidence on impacts both on the effects of evaluation on the developmental function of evaluation as well as the accountability function then we'll talk more specifically about the design features of teacher evaluation systems what we know about the performance measures that are that are incorporated into these systems, specifically classroom observations, which make up the overwhelming share of teachers' summative evaluation ratings

[02:08:30] based on annual evaluation. The consequences and some other considerations as you all are thinking about the design of teacher evaluation in the Commonwealth. So as Mr. Gecker mentioned, I am an associate professor of education and public policy.

[02:08:47] I also direct Ed Policy Forward, which is the Center for Education Policy at George Mason. My work looks at a range of issues the intersection of the economics of education education policy educator human capital urban school reform school finance and school discipline policy hello i'm seth hunter do i need to press anything no no okay um seth hunter i'm an assistant professor of education leadership at george mason my research focuses squarely on the policy effects of teacher evaluation as well as the practice of doing so that largely means how principals are implementing it since carrying out

[02:09:25] teacher evaluation is largely a school administrator function and also some work concerning instructional coaching and teacher leadership for school improvement and then for what it's worth a bit of my pre-academic and academic background i work in the kentucky department of education i was a part of the group that rolled out a revised set of instructional standards along with its evaluation system and was recently named an affiliated researcher with the tennessee education research Alliance, which advises their State Department of Education on matters of teacher evaluation

[02:10:02] and have recently begun a partnership with some Missouri teacher evaluation systems. Thanks, Seth. So let's jump into the core of the material here, and this shouldn't come as any surprise to folks in the room or online, is that teacher quality matters, right? Among all school level factors related to student learning and achievement, the student's teachers consistently across a number of years and multiple studies have been shown to be the most important factor for improving student outcomes.

[02:10:28] High-quality teaching is influential for student achievement, as well as socio-emotional and labor market outcomes. But importantly, right, teachers vary dramatically in their ability to improve student performance, right? There is significant heterogeneity, even within schools, in teacher effectiveness.

[02:10:45] So as a result, teacher quality is an ideal malleable factor for improving schooling outcomes. And how do we do that in the context of evaluation? Well, personnel evaluation in education really has been implemented for two broad purposes, as I alluded to just before.

[02:11:01] First, providing teachers with instructional guidance and feedback to improve their classroom instructional practice in order to improve student outcomes. And then there's also an accountability function, right, to identify, remediate, and when necessary, remove the lowest performing teachers in order to improve the quality distribution of the teacher labor force.

[02:11:22] And about 10 years ago, 12 years ago now in 2009, US DOE, under the Race to the Top grant, encouraged states and districts to overhaul, to really revise their approaches to measuring teacher

performance and evaluating teachers.

[02:11:39] And what this led to was a nationwide reform movement. Nearly all states, 46 of the 50 states in the US, and 22 of the 25 largest school districts by student enrollment, as well as DC, DC's impact system, implemented teacher evaluation reforms.

[02:11:55] So we've had systematic changes nationally the last 10 years to how we measure and evaluate teacher performance and this this map shows again the distribution of those reforms and i'll point to where we are now in virginia right this is one of the states as you all know that established guidelines for evaluating teacher performance but left discretion to districts around the design and implementation right in contrast to most states like Pennsylvania, for example, where I've worked under Act 82 in 2012, the state designed an evaluation system that was implemented at the district level across all 500 districts in

[02:12:33] Pennsylvania. So what do we know in terms of evidence on teacher evaluation impacts, right? So first, on the sort of function of providing teachers with instructional guidance and feedback to improve their performance, we've learned quite a bit over the last 10 years. In Chicago, i've done work that shows that a targeted low stakes and by low stakes we mean there was no accountability function built into the system right it was a pilot system that folk that provided focused rigorous and frequent classroom observation and importantly pre and post classroom

[02:13:08] observation feedback um to teachers that significantly in a causal way improve student achievement what's notable about this work in chicago is that and to cess point just before building principal and school leader capacity to implement these evaluation rubrics to observe to provide detailed instructional feedback to teachers was one of the key drivers in chicago's efforts for moving student achievement and again we can talk more about this either now i should have mentioned this at the beginning please feel free to ask questions i'm an economist so i'm already nervous that there have been no questions or at the end we're happy to take

[02:13:45] some time to have questions so in cincinnati and then i look back and i see and so in cincinnati teachers contributions to student achievement growth increased in the wake of this of that district's more rigorous again classroom observation based system and notably these improvements in teacher practice and teacher performance were concentrated among teachers who were the lowest performing in the district prior to the evaluation reform right so this idea that our lowest performers can't benefit from instructional feedback is certainly not the case right because again some of these teachers who are among our lower performers need that capacity building to develop their instructional skills

[02:14:24] more locally in DC right teachers who are at the margin of receiving disciplinary action right dismissal act for their low performance improved in the wake of evaluation in the subsequent school year and in cess work in rural Missouri he finds that evaluation for teacher development did not affect student achievement in the typical school but increased student achievement substantially in relatively disadvantaged and in particular rural schools right so again this this emergent theme that some of our most disadvantaged schools whether they're economically disadvantaged whether they're in more remote

[02:15:00] communities or our teachers are lower performing benefits significantly from instructional feedback again that is designed in a way to link their practices to student outcomes and what do we know about on the accountability side? On the accountability side, thinking about identifying and remediating teachers when necessary, we learn from Chicago, D.C., Houston, and an urban Tennessee district that

evaluation reforms can play a meaningful role in the removal of low-performing teachers. In the Chicago pilot evaluation system I previously referred

[02:15:37] to, we find that low-performing tenured teachers would not have exited the district in the absence of high-stakes consequences right so this is rather sorry this isn't in Chicago's more recent vintage the the reach system in Chicago that has high stakes accountability built into the system so that low-performing teachers right are given multiple opportunities to improve but when they don't they're removed and what we find in Chicago is that the removal of those teachers not only doesn't hurt but benefits students because those teachers are replaced by much higher performing teachers because again we're talking about the lowest one

[02:16:14] to five percent of the teacher performance distribution in Chicago that was removed in Houston researchers find that the introduction of evaluation reform increased exit from the district among the lowest performing teachers those in the bottom 20% of the teacher performance distribution but actually decreased exit for those that we would want to keep in the district right our highest performers but what's notable is that school administrators often retain their lowest performing teachers even in systems that allow for such removal. Why? Because there's concern about whether those teachers can be replaced with higher performers, right? And again, this depends largely on the local teacher labor

[02:16:52] market, right? In places like Northern Virginia, which has a robust teacher labor market, you can imagine removal of low-performing teachers being replaced with much higher performers. But in more rural communities, we need to think hard about, well, if we remove these lowest performers, what teachers can we bring into the system to replace these lowest performers to make sure that we're equitably implementing an evaluation system statewide and what's important to note right is the overall quality of new teachers nationally has improved in the wake of these systematic evaluation reforms even though the supply of the new teaching candidates

[02:17:28] has actually declined over time so before we move into some guidance around the design of evaluation systems are there any questions about what we know so far in terms of the existing evidence the extent literature on both the impacts of evaluation reform on instructional performance as well as on the remove the identification and removal of low-performing teachers yeah you don't mind please any idea what the magnitude of the effect is you know the magnitude we you know we've seen some research for example on you know board certified teachers you know uh although there's a clear positive you know statistically significant bump the amount of that bump is actually fairly

[02:18:08] marginal right it's three to five weeks or something it's not no and so here the outcome that you're focused on come for the students in terms of yeah it's a great question so in the work in Chicago this evaluation pilot that was focused entirely on classroom observations providing meaningful detailed pre and post observation feedback to students right this is like the impact on student achievement was effectively moving a school or the average performance in the school from low performing, so the 10th percentile, to close to the 30th or 40th percentile of the distribution. So a significant increase in student performance. Now on the accountability

[02:18:48] side, we're also talking about a big increase in the exit of low performers. In Chicago, again, and I'll turn to Seth in a moment to see if there's anything to add on this point, but we also see a significant increase in the exit of the lowest performing teachers, a 50% increase in Chicago among low performing tenured teachers. One of the key concerns of evaluation as we know is that there are some concerns about

whether or not low performing tenured teachers remain or not given the contractual protections in many places that that prevent those teachers from from being dismissed but that's in fact what we what we see in Chicago is those teachers leave at high rates under the evaluation reform but in terms of moving student outcomes and

[02:19:25] we're not talking about monumental changes in student achievement and I think your point is exactly right but system-wide even marginal changes in student achievement certainly accumulate. Just to piggyback on what Matthew said, so when the Cincinnati system was introduced, it increased student achievement about a tenth of a standard deviation, which most researchers would characterize as a moderate to even maybe potentially large increase. In the research I've done in Missouri, one of the important caveats is that we were

[02:20:00] looking at rural schools exclusively, no urban schools. Missouri is largely rural, and the system we were looking at was marketed specifically to rural schools because the designers believed that some of the school administrators' needs would differ based on urbanicity. And when looking at rural schools exclusively, again, on average, we found no effect. So virtually, not one, so Mr.

[02:20:25] Gecker brought up statistical significance. And when I say no effect, I don't mean there was something, there was a change that we couldn't detect statistically. It was a zero, a change of zero in terms of student achievement. But when we looked at schools that had higher concentrations of low, higher concentrations of less experienced teachers, higher concentrations of black and brown students in generally more disadvantaged schools, the positive effects were on the order of those in Cincinnati. So I don't know that there's enough work out there yet to make sense

[02:21:02] of that urbanicity explanation, but the evidence tells us not massive improvements, but most would characterize them as moderately high to potentially high. Are you able to get to the level of understanding where, I'm not going to be able to phrase this the way I really mean it, but if you have a school that has got a disproportionately high number of younger teachers, inexperienced teachers, is the effect different? I mean, Does that explain any of the differences between what you're seeing in the rural setting

[02:21:41] where I think you just said there are a higher number of inexperienced teachers compared to a different setting where perhaps the building mix is different? - I'll just talk about it. - So in the Missouri context, when we were, what we did is we effectively compared schools after the adoption of a next generation system, evaluation system, the type that was called for and raised to the top.

[02:22:08] when we looked at schools that adopted this system and we looked at those that had just among the rural schools that adopted it and we looked at those that had a larger concentration of experienced teachers relative to those that had less experience it was the schools with less experienced teachers that performed better we don't the explanation at this point is unclear i mean conceptually you might argue that those are on the evaluation for development side that's precisely the group of teachers for whom you would expect a system like this to to help there's also

[02:22:44] some emerging work i'm working on in tennessee that suggests that the feedback component specifically that's provided to teachers after their observations by their typically school administrator that may clarify teacher performance expectations so you learn in you know teacher preparation programs oh here's what i do on the job as a teacher you also pick up some of that knowledge on the job some emerging

evidence suggests that the observation process may also provide school administrators an opportunity to clarify even further and this was again for very

[02:23:20] inexperienced teachers what the principal's expectations were what good performance looks like and then you have the processes that follow that matthew brought up about professional development i think yeah and i think it's really important here not to understate the importance of evaluators and school leaders in the process right the pilot that we that i mentioned in chicago from way back in 2008 9 provided 50 hours of principal training to school leaders this was in the summer of 2008 as well as throughout the 0809 year where principals met in teams with other school leaders

[02:23:57] that were part of this it's called the excellence in teaching project in chicago the eitp and that 50 hours, right, really develop the skills for school leaders to identify instructional deficiencies among teachers, work with teachers to not only identify those but suggest alternative instructional approaches, and that's what we see were driving the results.

[02:24:18] How do we know that? Because in the second year, when the control schools took up the EITP intervention, principals received less than three hours of training, and we see zero effects in the second year, right? So we think about the design of the system in Virginia. need to think hard about what is the capacity for training providing support not just initially but ongoing for our school leaders to do this work right to do the as it'll show in a few moments the four or five observations per teacher that systems nationwide under their evaluation reforms are currently or at least in principle conducting for each teacher right so again thinking about how

[02:24:54] adding that administrative burden in some ways to teach on principles can be supported and so that they can view that as instructional guidance and instructional opportunities for instructional improvement and not just an additional administrative role that they now have to fulfill.

[02:25:10] Clarifying question and basic basic basic assumption question when we look at teacher success you've said or underperforming performing are the research studies that you're referencing solely based on student achievement results moving proficiency does it have any growth measures involved is are you seeing any students work you know in virginia we've moved to some growth assessments are they so what are they based on when you're saying success or teachers were successful went to performing so i think that's a very important nuance as we consider virginia really important so here we're typically talking about student achievement on state standardized

[02:25:48] exams right so movement in the distribution of student performance on those exams right there's been far less work done on things like how do how does evaluation systems affect other student outcomes whether it's behavioral outcomes we you know we i mentioned earlier on that you know teachers can move in a positive way the socio and emotional outcomes of students but those outcomes have really not been looked at in the context of the impact of these evaluation systems so on the state that you're referring the state you're referring to is it just how many of their students were proficient period or how many of them were on grade level period or was there any indication of

[02:26:24] any growth proficient to advanced or move from below base some states have below basic basic categories is it certain students move from below basic to basic but they weren't proficient or was it purely how many students were now proficient or at grade level as an indicator of success it's a great question so typically the way that achievement is measured in these studies is looking at growth in student performance as opposed to you know what share what proportion of students move from basic to

proficient right because again the idea is you know we know this from the accountability literature from the last 15 years is that you know much of the school accountability accountability literature shows that teachers can kind

[02:27:01] of game that system when the system is based on proficiency rates by targeting those students at the middle of the distribution just below and just above the the cut point for proficiency so typically researchers will say let's look at the full distribution of student performance and see if that system moves not you know on average student performance but also the cesspoint where those students you know fall on the distribution of initial performance right and again we see the benefits are not necessarily concentrated among low or high performers right but they're definitely concentrated in terms of improving the instructional performance of our lowest performing teachers right thank you who we who we also know tend to be teaching in some of our lowest in schools with our lowest performers which means that if our lowest performing teachers

[02:27:41] are benefiting the most from this instructional guidance then almost definitionally our lowest performing students will as well thank you for your question yes um real quickly were paper Are performance plans an element in any of these evaluation reforms in any of these locations?

[02:27:59] Yeah, the only system that I know of, the only evaluation system that I know of that has a merit-based component is DC's impact system, right? Where the highest performers could receive permanent salary increases up to $25,000, $30,000. Chicago does, and Chicago only has accountability sanctions for low performers.

[02:28:18] I don't know any other system that has the type of merit-based features that DC's impact system has. thank you great so let's talk then a little bit about what yeah i'm sorry at least we've eliminated one fear of yours there were at least a few questions please the more the better we i came down here from dc so i'm happy to take as many questions as you can as you have so let's talk a little bit about what a system might look like right so in 2015 as you all know the every student succeeds act right signaled a new era for evaluation reform why because under essa states

[02:28:54] and districts have greater autonomy to design and implement teacher evaluation systems independent of federal influence and as state and district policy makers certainly you all in the room and those off outside the room can consider these consider revising um and making systematic changes to virginia's evaluation system there's some really key issues that that we think that need to be considered and addressed so first and we'll talk through each of these you know throughout the rest of the our conversation today first which measures of teacher performance are going to be incorporated into teachers ratings we'll talk about what those measures might look like what

[02:29:30] weight what nominal weight should be assigned to each of those performance measures how should a teacher's summative evaluation rating be constructed from these multiple performance measures what are the consequences that could be attached to teacher ratings and to dr roberson's i hope i'm pronouncing that correctly dr roberson's point are there also opportunities for incorporating merit-based rewards for high performers in the system as well do districts have the human capital capacity necessary to implement rigorous observations of classroom instructional practice again do districts have the capacity to do the professional development and training

[02:30:09] to build the capacity of school leaders to do this work critically important feature of evaluation reform design and then ultimately how to integrate evaluation and professional development into these

new systems so recent reforms to teacher evaluation systems have incorporated multiple measures of teacher performance into summative annual evaluation ratings. So these include, among others, standards-based classroom observation rubrics. One of the most widespread nationally is the Danielson Framework for Teaching or the FFT. There are other rubrics

[02:30:46] like the CLASS or PLATO, which define and measure teacher performance across multiple instructional domains. Second, student test score-based measures, such as value-added measures. So again, what's the teachers individual contribution to student achievement growth as well as student growth percentiles which is another measure of student growth but what's notable here right is that nationally only about 30% of teachers can we construct BAM for value-added measures because only for about 30% of our teachers nationally are they teaching and tested grades and subjects for which we actually have a pre and post state accountability exam third

[02:31:24] teacher developed measures of student learning sometimes referred to a student learning objectives, and student surveys. So these are just four types of measures that have been incorporated into systems, and we'll look at what the weights and distribution of those measures look like nationally in these new systems.

[02:31:43] And importantly, evidence from the Measures of Effective Teaching study, this is the Gates Foundation-funded study from 08, 09, and 9, 10, showed that composite measures of teacher performance that are based on not one, but multiple measures, can accurately identify and distinguish teacher effectiveness, right?

[02:32:00] these individual measures provide some information but together they provide significantly more information to help us differentiate teacher effectiveness so what how are states and districts nationally who have revised their evaluation systems these 46 states and 22 districts plus dc weighted the evaluation components right so what i show here is each column is a different teacher performance measure classroom observation value added student growth percentile student learning objectives, student surveys, and other measures. They could be school-wide measures of performance,

[02:32:37] parent or peer surveys. And what we see first is that about half of a teacher's summative evaluation is based on classroom observations, right? 54, 52 percent at the state and district levels, right? So half of a teacher's performance rating depends on classroom observations. But a meaningful share between 20 and 30 percent relies on student test scores, whether they're VAM or student growth percentiles and a much smaller share relies on these student learning objectives which again are locally developed measures that typically have very little variation within a district across teachers right in terms of their

[02:33:13] performance distribution questions here before we move on so here we're looking at the frequency of the use of each of these teacher performance measures in the state and district evaluation systems that I mentioned these 46 states in these 23 districts including dc and we see first that classroom observations are incorporated into all of these systems right the dark vertical bar are the states and the lighter vertical bar are the largest districts right we see that states and districts certainly incorporate student test

[02:33:51] score measures districts typically rely on value-added measures that rely that that require a little bit more statistical expertise to actually construct they control for student and classroom characteristics where student growth percentiles another way to incorporate student test scores typically

compares a student's teacher to a student to another like student in another teachers class and looks at their growth over time without the types of statistical adjustments that value-added measures typically make in the construction of those teacher specific scores and then again you see the other measures are incorporated at lower rates across these different systems but again as guidance for Virginia's you are considering what

[02:34:31] are the performance measures that we might consider incorporating into our system as I mentioned as we just saw classroom observations continue to make up the the majority and in some cases the overwhelming share of a teachers of annual evaluation rating right for the reasons that I mentioned VAM is is difficult rather impossible to construct for most of our teachers given the difficulty of linking students but also the fact that we don't have test scores for linked to students and teachers for most of our teachers nationally so given

[02:35:10] the classroom observations make up the majority though again not the entirety of a teacher summative evaluation rating how frequently are classroom observations of teacher practice actually being conducted at least based on the design of these state and district systems and in the first two columns so we've broken up this this table into career teachers so these are typically what you would consider your tenured teachers or teachers with more than three years of experience in beginning teachers or novice teachers those who are in their first three years in the profession and what we see among the career teachers both at the state and district levels that have revised their evaluation systems is that they're conducting at least based on

[02:35:47] the policy between four and five observations per teacher per year right now to the extent the extent to which these observations require pre and post observation conferences with teachers varies across these these localities and districts and states but again between four and five observations per year per teacher and then at the district level for novice teachers on average six observations now the extent to which this is actually being conducted is another question right but again in principle what does this mean it means that we're asking our school leaders to take on huge responsibility

[02:36:23] for doing for conducting the observations for being the instructional leader in the building to work with every teacher on their instructional practice so really again i would pose this this important task to the to the board and to others that really thinking hard about how we build the capacity among our school leaders to do this important work because again it's necessary to to build that capacity if we're going to effectively implement a rigorous classroom observation system that is not um the type of superficial observations that we've seen in the past that really don't have any effect on either practice or student performance. Please. So, a quick note about, like,

[02:37:03] compliance with a policy like this, at least in the state of Tennessee. So, Tennessee assigns its lowest performing teachers a minimum of four observations. Districts can add on to that if they want to. Teachers in the middle receive either four or two based on their years of experience, and then the highest performing teachers are assigned one. The idea being that, again, when thinking about the developmental aspect of these policies, the lower performing teachers are the ones who need higher dosages of feedback through these observation processes.

[02:37:36] And what a colleague and I find when we were looking to see the extent to which principals were complying with this is that by and large, 80% of all of the teachers in the state were receiving the policy prescribed number.

[02:37:51] There were some who were receiving one or two fewer observations than they were assigned. One of the takeaways, I think, though to consider is with that piece of information, if Virginia teachers are similar to Tennessee teachers, if the state were to adopt, say, like a default or recommended number, it seems like at least in the case of Tennessee, administrators stick fairly close to that number.

[02:38:20] So if you were to set, say, two observations per year, maybe the majority follow that, but you're likely to get deviation from that as well, where some teachers only receive one. If you were to set something like a bar of four, perhaps based on the evidence from Tennessee, most follow that recommendation, but some are going to receive slightly fewer.

[02:38:41] Well, for those who don't follow the policy prescription, what that amounts to is in a state that's assigning its teachers, let's just say two, you're going to have maybe 20% of your teachers who are only receiving one observation, right? Because they're deviating from that bar of two and they're not conducting one.

[02:38:59] If you happen to think that observations are important, however, setting a higher threshold, knowing that some are unlikely to comply, is still likely to keep teachers close to whatever threshold you set as a board. Question. I'm curious. Can you speak to the size of the schools that have been included in some of these studies just to appreciate the number of staff that essentially administrators are through on this policy?

[02:39:36] i'm just curious what do you know about the average size of the school the average size of the schools in terms of student enrollment and teacher staff well in terms of staff right because ultimately that's where the burden lives and i'm just curious to sort of understand given the level of compliance that you've just articulated exists i'm just curious to to understand that so i in tennessee this is statewide so it's every every public and public charter in the state um again Tennessee was one of the initial recipients of Race to the Top, so they also had substantial capital to invest in this system. But this is every teacher, every single school in the state.

[02:40:17] In Tennessee, a colleague of mine at NYU and I, we were looking, we wanted to understand the administrative burden, so to speak, of conducting observations specifically. And I'd say some of the more important takeaways are that administrators are savvy and they find ways to implement what may seem like a large number of observations among their cadre of assistant principals and principals, and they are not assigning who observes, if Mr. Gecker is a teacher, they're not assigning who observed Mr. Gecker randomly. They're coming together and they're

[02:40:57] talking about who, which assistant principal seems to be best positioned or might be best positioned to observe Mr. Gecker. We also know from some of the, from research from the earliest days of Race to the Top, a small-scale interview-based study found that principals reported that these conducting observations was a very heavy burden. And I think that makes a lot of sense, especially in the early days of a transition. You're going from a system where teachers might have been observed once every year to maybe once every three years to a new system where now you're

[02:41:33] saying, you know, four observations per teacher. But again, in Tennessee, when we look at what's happened when, I mean, almost 10 years now after the system has been in place, we were able to collect survey responses from administrators asking them specifically about the burdens of teacher evaluation. And at this point, there's those reported burdens in the state of Tennessee are principals who

are conducting more observations and their colleagues in a different school do not report any more burdens from across schools. And again, we think that's because

[02:42:11] administrators have figured out ways how to manage these observations so that they're not becoming too cumbersome. Initially, you would likely expect, you know, reported burdens, but several years into the system, we don't see that exist. And these districts, you know, from which at least the existing evidence comes from Chicago, Houston, D.C., right, these are fairly big urban districts the school you know with large schools so again i think to seth's point the

[02:42:47] question is to what extent are these systems being implemented with fidelity which is a real concern i think that is likely your point right to what extent are principals able to do this work in schools that's that have lots of features i think what i heard in their response is that it's just not as the principal is not the only person that's right and i i mean that's really as i'm hearing you reference principal. I wanted to really unpack. Is that alone or in concert with others to support the process?

[02:43:15] No, it's a great question. So in Chicago, probably 80 percent of the observations are conducted by principals and the remaining 20 by assistant principals in the building. And what's important to note in a place like Chicago is those principals and assistant principals are receiving certification to actually conduct the observations still under the new system.

[02:43:35] But yes, I think that the burden is being distributed across building leaders within a building. Thank you. Dr. Duran. I think I appreciate this conversation, but I just want to comment more than a question.

[02:43:54] I feel that as we think about policy with regards to teacher evaluation, the notion of the number of observations or the consistency is an important part, but to me what's more important is the quality of those observations, the instructional coaching model that goes into really setting goals sitting down with teachers really getting to understand what their strengths what their needs are going in and observing getting some data coming back and reflecting and that might mean less observations formally and more opportunities to have a thorough coaching process because having been a principal assistant principal you can go in and do a lot of

[02:44:31] those and they're not meaningful when you have you know 40 50 people sometimes to do three or four for the year i mean that's 120 that's a lot i've had to do that before so when you have so many observations to have to just do to get done because the policy says and we want to be compliant what is the real impact that you're going to have on either student achievement or teacher long-term growth you might get some short-term you know compliance things that you're getting them to do but in effect you're not really helping them long term so i worry and this is my comment i worry when we get into discussions at the policy level of how many observations you have to do absent what does that really look like what and you talked about

[02:45:10] the training that would go into place but really balancing that because it might mean less observations if you follow a true coaching model cycle that takes time and it takes a lot of time when you really go in and give that deep feedback and to dr man's point there's only so many administrators that can do that so if you wanted them to do that well then we have to like find a happy medium and i don't know what that is but it's just a comment i wanted to make as i'm listening i'm thinking of the reality of the observations i've done as a principal as an assistant principal and those that were able to have a real coaching model opportunity to experience

[02:45:46] that took me much more time yeah hugely important struggle with that in my head that's all this one one one suggestion is as you all consider rolling out a new system maybe doing it in a staggered way in the first year or two where you can potentially randomly assign to certain schools one two three observations at minimum for their teachers to really get a sense empirically over the first year or two, right? Where is that sort of sweet spot? Is it two? Is three too much of a burden?

[02:46:17] Is one not enough to build the sort of, like you said, Dr. Durant, this sort of consistent feedback process over the school year. So just again, thinking about how do we get some traction on this question about what's the optimal number of observations to conduct? There's ways empirically to sort of think at the front end about how we can actually design a pilot rollout to give us a sense, again, empirically, where that sweet spot is in terms of the most productive use of principal and teacher time with respect to this observation process.

[02:46:46] And it may not be the case that all teachers are assigned the same number of observations. Again, in Tennessee and in other places, whether you're thinking about evaluation as a developmental or in terms of accountability or development, who would you just suspect that principals would like to observe the most?

[02:47:04] It's likely the less effective teachers. And the less experienced. And the less experienced. And so you may assign that group of teachers, again, a minimum number, districts could add to it potentially, and then the more experienced, more effective teachers could receive fewer observations.

[02:47:24] So it may not be the same across the board for everybody. And in most cases, it's not. So in Chicago, again, for example, tenured teachers receive their four observations across two years. Untenured teachers, so these are teachers in their first three years, receive four in principal in each year until they get tenure.

[02:47:42] So again, I think to Seth's point, thinking about ways to better target the observation process to teachers that need the most instructional support but also who could benefit the most from that ongoing developmental feedback.

[02:47:59] In one of your responses, you all mentioned, I believe, training for the individuals who are actually conducting the evaluations or the observations. you talk a little bit about what that looks like because as we're talking about kind of the capacity in a building yeah who all it may be principals or in my experience assistant principals or department chairs so so that responsibility kind of trickles down yeah yeah so in the work in earlier work that i did in chicago again this excellence in teaching project from 2008-9 were in chicago under then ceo arne duncan they randomly assigned this evaluation pilot across 100 cps

[02:48:38] chicago public school elementary schools and again in the first year of that pilot where about 45 schools took on this new system again the system being based on the danielson rubric multiple observations per teacher with pre and post observation conferences the school leaders in that building the principals in in the in the treatment schools in that first year received 50 hours of ongoing professional development over the school year so what did that include and again i I can send the paper to the board where it gives much more detail on the exact training of the school leaders.

[02:49:10] But what it entailed effectively was training in the summer prior to the '08-'09 school year where principals met amongst themselves 45 principals with trainers from the district to work with them

on sort of building their capacity to understand, well, what are we looking for in teacher observations?

[02:49:26] It's different from this checklist that had been in the system since the '70s, right? And Dr. Doran, you mentioned just walking to the classroom, right? moving away from that system but providing this early training prior to the school year and then notably these principal training teams that met on an ongoing basis throughout the school year where principals and school leaders could trade and discuss but what works what doesn't work how does that inform my observation process the practice right in the school and then in the second year and we see you know significant effects on student achievement driven by growth and teacher instructional practice in the second year where those other 45 or

[02:50:02] schools that were the control schools in the first year took on EITP this excellence in teaching project only about three hours of total principal professional development was provided we see zero effects in the second year right so which really suggests to us it's that capacity building and again we're happy to provide we can provide more detail specifically on what the training was and the Chicago consortium has done a lot of work also on on sort of what was the training in Chicago for these principles what did it look like like to provide a framework or a model that potentially can inform this work

[02:50:36] here yeah thanks dr. Wilson no question okay so what are some of the consequences that have built into these new systems you know as many of you know one criticism of traditional systems evaluation again these systems that relied on these very cursory checklists and walkthroughs of teacher of teacher practice is that few formal consequences resulted from low performance on in terms of teacher summative evaluation rating so here we're talking about about really the accountability mechanism or the accountability function of these systems.

[02:51:09] And so in the wake of these reforms at the state and district levels, policymakers have actually taken a more developmental approach toward evaluation. So this table shows among the 46 states that revise their evaluation systems and the 23 districts that revise their systems, what share of these systems incorporated different evaluation consequences.

[02:51:30] You can see about 80%, 74 to 80% or so district and state systems provided more professional development for low performing teachers right so again taking this professional development stance towards evaluation there was certainly an increase in the in the share of systems that led to termination for low performance or even tenure revocation and then to dr. Roberson's point far fewer take an approach that incorporates merit-based pay into these systems but again the key bit here right is that these systems are recognizing that the key feature of these systems is

[02:52:09] to build instructional capacity among teachers and one way to do that even among our low performers right is to take a more professional development approach to their practice rather than a median accountability responses so as you're thinking again about the redesign of Virginia system there's some other real important design considerations that we want to close on today so in In addition to the performance measures, the associated weights, and the consequences for low performance in these systems, there are other considerations for you all to address in the design of these systems.

[02:52:48] First, what are the ratings categories and the associated ratings thresholds that are used to define and determine the level of teacher performance, right? So historically, and this comes out of the widget effect in 2009 from the new teacher Project, which showed that most systems that had binary evaluation ratings, satisfactory or unsatisfactory for teachers, 94, 99% of teachers were rated satisfactory.

So that really spurred this evaluation reform movement that increased the number of ratings categories to, in most cases, four, some cases, five categories of teacher summative performance.

[02:53:24] It's also important to think about what's the threshold at which we set the various performance ratings right so one approach could be we want to force a distribution of teacher performance ratings right meaning we want to have you know 15% of teachers in category one let's say that's the low category or 15 percent at the top category and then some other distribution in the center so you could think about what are the ratings thresholds that we would actually assign that would construct a distribution of teacher ratings like that or is there a more sort of proficiency based approach where we say this is the proficient level, and if 100% of teachers reach this level, then 100% of teachers

[02:54:01] are rated in the proficiency category. So again, thinking about where that ratings threshold is set, because it very much determines what we say about teacher performance. Second, and importantly, do teacher ratings account for contextual factors? What do we mean by that? Well, recent evidence from myself and others shows that the characteristics of a teacher's students and observer's expectations, Seth's work, regarding teacher performance, independent of the context, influences the measurement of teacher quality via classroom observations. So what do we mean by that?

[02:54:39] So in some work that I've done using the measures of effective teaching study data, where in the second year of the study they randomly assigned teachers to rosters of students, we were able to look at, well, what's the effect of randomly, as a teacher, getting lower performing students on my classroom observation scores? And guess what we find? We find that teachers who were randomly assigned to students with lower incoming achievement received lower classroom observation ratings. Teachers in that same study who were randomly assigned larger shares of poor and minority students also had lower scores. So this idea that classroom observations are context dependent. Thinking about ways

[02:55:19] in which you might adjust for those characteristics in the construction of teachers' classroom observation scores. And why is that so important? because in some recent work in chicago from with my colleague lawrence artane at unc chapel hill we find that black teachers in chicago public schools receive lower classroom observation scores on average than their non-black peers this has been found in michigan more recently and in other states right and these race specific differences are largely attributable to differences in the school context in which teachers in chicago work black teachers disproportionately are teaching on the south side right in communities with higher poverty higher

[02:55:56] crime right and not to differences in teacher quality is measured by teacher van this is such an important point right if we're gonna base our the overwhelming share of a teacher's final rating which is professionally meaningful right both for retention dismissal reasons and the predominant measure classroom observations in and of itself reflects to a large extent the students to which a teacher is assigned and not the teacher's instructional performance then we need to think hard about what adjustments will the system make statistical adjustments which are very straightforward to make in fact i'm working with chicago public schools right now to revise their system to account for the fact that these

[02:56:33] contextual factors influence teachers classroom observation scores so again really important to think about what are some of these contextual factors at the local level the very local level the classroom and school level that may influence what we say about teacher performance and as a The complement to the statistical adjustment can happen on the back end of this process, right?

[02:56:55] Scores are generated. There may appear to be bias, which, by the way, virtually every measure of performance has some degree of bias. So no measure is perfect, whether we're talking about value-added, observation scores, et cetera. It's just that Matthew and others, myself included, have found substantial degrees of bias in some cases.

[02:57:16] so I just wanted to make the point that complementing the statistical adjustment is on the front end that rigorous professional development for the observers themselves and the ongoing support that they may need to maintain to the extent possible bias-free observations.

[02:57:39] And this is a hugely important point, right? Because to put a finer point on it, when we're looking at, again, Chicago Public Schools, based on classroom observation scores, the typical black teacher is at the 37th percentile of the classroom observation score distribution the typical white teacher in chicago is at the 50th 55th percentile and this difference is not a function of teacher effectiveness when we look at teachers contribution to student achievement growth on state standardized tests this is entirely a function we can explain away the entirety of this black white gap in teacher classroom observation scores as a function of the differences in the classroom and school context in which teachers work so it's really important

[02:58:18] to think about if we want to have a statewide system that meaningfully measures and differentiates aims to differentiate teacher effectiveness the extent to which factors outside of a teacher's control influence their scores is something that we need to be aware of and address in the design of the system so we just want to conclude on just a couple points on um incorporating evaluation and professional development systems though frankly you know my perspective is that a rigorous classroom observation-based evaluation system is in and of itself a PD system, right, as we find in Chicago and under the Excellence in Teaching Project. But importantly, evaluation feedback,

[02:58:56] you know, may not improve teaching directly, right, it may instead point to, point teachers to targeted PD opportunities, whether that's coaching, peer observation, or other workshops. But importantly, and Seth has been doing some great work on this, evaluation and PD system integration does not necessarily seem to drive evaluation's positive effects on students. It's really about the features of the evaluation system and the extent to which the evaluation system recognizes supports and promotes instructional development among teachers with guided instructional coaching among school leaders that's driving the student achievement improvements that we observe

[02:59:32] in these systems one point on a specific example of how when we use this word integration what that might look like uh an example that i'm familiar with has on the um on the teacher's observation rubric, there's performance indicators that they're judged against. So in Virginia, there are the standards and then there are the bullets underneath those standards. You can imagine an online, like an online professional development library with online modules that are linked to specific bullet points under those standards. And so if a principal or assistant principal or

[03:00:11] whomever decides that a teacher needs to receive some PD, beyond the feedback that the principal provides immediately regarding his questioning skills. The principal can flag that and then point the teacher to this online repository of professional development resources, and the teacher can find resources linked to that area of improvement precisely. That's not the only way to do it. That is a clever way that I've heard of. There's also, again, other just generally

[03:00:45] effective methods like those that are on the slide, coaching and peer mentoring. So with that, well, thank you for your time and for giving us the opportunity to talk with you today and, again, open up for other questions that you might have. Thanks.

[03:01:01] Yeah, James. Thank you both for your presentation. Part of the logic model that I sense that you're thinking is that one of the important factors in an evaluation model is to be able to remove low-performing teachers from the classroom and therefore by removing low performing teachers you know you would replace them with a higher performing teacher and then student achievement will approve well on what august 15th 76 school divisions reported to us that there were 4922 vacancies in virginia and i don't think

[03:01:36] we're going to fire our way to success i think that's an older way of thinking about how we're going to improve the classroom we're going to have to take the people that we have in addition to taking those that are significantly underperforming and use our coaching between the principal and the teacher coaches to raise the level of people that are there if we actually hope to solve this issue. And we've been awaiting this presentation for some time. When I look at the questions that you put out there for the board to ponder, and I think there are a lot of questions that the board

[03:02:13] can think differently on, but at the heart of it, most of what you've asked us to consider, the board has considered in the previous evaluation system and essentially a lot of what we're seeing here is you suggesting maybe we need uh more frequent observations but i can't tell what you're actually suggesting is different than what's in the current system other than maybe more frequent evaluations maybe student surveys even though there's certainly i can pull up research that suggests there are reliability issues with student surveys as well but what what are you suggesting the board might do that's different than what's in their current

[03:02:50] system so I guess the first question I have is how are you going about in the current system building the capacity of local school leaders to work with teachers on the instructor element side right have you reviewed our system you know I'm I'm asking the question yes and we've looked at the system sure now in fact this part is one of my courses at Mason my students bring in the pop their local policies their policy reports and one of the things that we

[03:03:27] consistently find is when it comes to the policies and the practice, that type of support is not recognized by any of my students. Additionally, and in particular, the conferences that are preceding and following conferences, I mean, an observation, so the pre-conference, the observation, the post-conference, that's not to say that it doesn't exist at all, but the students are surprised when I share this kind of information with them because

[03:04:03] what seems to be happening is, well, it doesn't seem to be happening, at least among my students in Northern Virginia, which includes Fairfax, Prince William, Loudoun, Arlington, Alexandria, and others. So I guess I would say, and when we read state policy as well, because we look at state policy, we look at district, and we look at school policy, the extent to which these ideas are present in Virginia state policy is less clear than if we were to look at how other

[03:04:41] states describe these. And some of that, you might use the word, some other states are more prescriptive than the Virginia state policy reads. So, for example, the observation question. Other states set that expectation at a state level. My students report wildly different numbers of observations in practice

that they've received themselves. These are teachers. I teach, I teach rising administrators who are predominantly current classroom teachers. And even within the same

[03:05:14] district, there's substantial variation from school to school. So I, I get my answer to your question would be, I think in principle, several of these ideas are here, but if you were to do a document to document comparison between Virginia and another state, the extent to the clarity or or maybe the specificity of these elements in Virginia policy is less clear than what I've seen in other systems.

[03:05:44] - Right, well, we can certainly talk about this offline, but it seems like part of what you're saying is that by adding clarity to the current system or maybe even being more prescriptive, it's not so much the system that needs to change, but maybe the mandates that the board puts on things that are maybe suggested or recommended in the system and the divisions are making their own decisions.

[03:06:08] I would just say I agree that there is likely inconsistency in the number of observations from one district to the next, because we offer a lot of flexibility for that. I would agree with that. I would also say that the extent to which principals are appropriately implementing the pre-observation and post-observation meetings is probably somewhat inconsistent based on local policy.

[03:06:41] So I see how we could be more prescriptive there. But there's so much research that's growing on how we can better create standards and trainings for principals around how to observe the interactions between teachers and students.

[03:07:00] I'm just really surprised that that wasn't addressed today. I think -- so when we are discussing the role that observations play, that's what we're referring to. Is so, so to be clear, so an observation would refer to, so it may be announced or unannounced.

[03:07:21] We set up time with a, if I'm the principal, I set up time with the teacher, go in their classroom, spend, as, as was mentioned, some systems might implement several, like many observations that might last like 15 minutes on average. Others may set up, though, a process where the, the principal is in the classroom or the assistant principal or whoever, whomever for 30 to 30 minutes, 40 minutes.

[03:07:46] And again, I think that's not something that a state board should legislate because those minutes are going to depend on teacher needs. But the structure of the observation rubric, right? To what extent does the state mandate an observation rubric that is shown to be linked to not only performance standards, but also to instructional practice that's linked to student outcomes, right?

[03:08:06] One of the features of Pennsylvania's system, Act 82, is that they take the Danielson framework and mandate that be the framework unless districts request and receive waivers from the state to implement at the local level and the Danielson framework has empirically been shown to identify instructional practices that are linked to student outcomes our read of the state policy based on the William and Mary faculty suggestions is nothing is divorced entirely from a framework that seems to be linked in the same way that the Danielson framework is to instructional performance and student outcomes

[03:08:39] So one key suggestion that emerges out of this right in our suggestions is to more formalize as Seth said the types of descriptions that are required of districts rather than to allow for local description, which very much could be divorced from good practice, right?

[03:08:54] Or set, again, the Tennessee model, it effectively sets floors, and it will say the state expects a certain minimum characteristic, minimum number of observations, minimum number of hours of principal professional development.

[03:09:10] Districts and schools may add to those, but the state sets the floor to ensure some equitable, if you look at just the developmental side, right, to ensure some equitable teacher development opportunities across the state. If some -- if some districts are deciding on their own to conduct a meaningful classroom observation of the type you're describing for a teacher, maybe just once -- for a teacher, let's just say an ineffective teacher, and they're deciding they only need that once a year, I'd say their students are not as well off as they could be had that district decided to

[03:09:48] increase the observations for that group of teachers, and that That may be a role that state policy could play is in setting some of those minimum expectations that districts could add on to. And I think your point, Dr. Lane, on the accountability side is not wrong, right?

[03:10:03] That when we talk about Chicago and dismissing teachers and replacing them with higher-performing teachers, we're talking about 1% of the teachers in Chicago. So in no way, I think, and I think you're right on this point, is that we're going to fire our way to better distribution of teacher performance.

[03:10:21] So certainly every system nationally, as we said, you know, a couple of slides before, has put its weight on the professional development side, right, in terms of the consequences for low performance and not the dismissal side. Now there may be some suggestions or guidance from the state around ways to reward high performers, for example, in a more distributed leadership approach where high performing teachers are rewarded not just with higher pay, but more responsibilities to help alleviate the burden of administrators to conduct these classroom observations.

[03:10:51] So I'm sorry there was little value in this presentation, but, you know. Thank you for what you have shared. I really think it's important information. I would just encourage the board as we go through this process over the next few months, and certainly if our partners from George Mason are able to come back, to let's spend a little bit more of our time in the coming months on what we want that framework to look like.

[03:11:19] I think the mechanics of how many and who can do them and, you know, how they're rated, think that those are all things that we can work out with our committee of practitioners and and all of that but i i really think that what i was hoping we would do is help the board identify the the type of framework that you want to go after we can build the rules around that framework once we better understand that so certainly yeah now that's a great point so the you know the danielson framework for teaching is the most widespread observation rubric it's empirically been linked like i mentioned the teacher practice and student achievement the studies that look at again measures

[03:11:55] of teacher performance based on these classroom observation scores are based on typically the danielson framework for teaching so that might be a rubric to begin with we can send you information both from my research and other research out of chicago on the capacity building efforts around excellent the excellence in teaching project in terms of going back to dr wilson's question building capacity and training of our school administrators so there are certainly direct guidance on the on the measures to select the weights that may be associated with those measures efforts to build capacity of school leaders that that information exists right i think

[03:12:31] you know certainly we can only do so much in the time that we have but yes dr lane to your point we're this is what seth and i work on we're thrilled to help support the state's effort and what we you know from a professional perspective is so important from a personal perspective you know seth and i were both classroom teachers at one point in our lives so this is hugely important you know to to the work that we do but to you know to the work that i know that you're doing and certainly for the students in the state miss halton hi hi so i've been staying silent since i get to talk to these smart guys all the time and deferring to you all

[03:13:07] but if we have time for one more question and if not maybe we could get this uh but uh feedback from you in some other way but if we were to if we as a board wanted to look at one or two other state systems as a model to start with, you know, to contrast with what we're doing now, compare and contrast using your data but also your professional judgment.

[03:13:35] Is there one or two that you think are real standout? I think it would be worth -- we probably need to think about that a little more, Ann. There has been, despite the number of rural students in the United States, there has not been a lot of research conducted in rural school systems on this matter, so I think it would be important to identify a state that has research from a state and some policies that have been used by rural educators. There's far more research and information available from more urban centers, but that's

[03:14:13] something we can think about, Ann, and talk through. On the observation piece, Dr. Lane, I just wanted to say that we call them the standards in my class, but the document that just added the culturally responsive standard?

[03:14:29] Yep. Okay. So that tool identifies those performance, like the standards, the performance goals. And so just to put a fine point on it, that alone has been a tremendous amount of work to get that type of document.

[03:14:47] That's a major hurdle to overcome. The next step to make it something similar to the tool that's used in these other systems would be then to be able to map out some of those standards across performance levels. And I know that there's some examples in the document that do that.

[03:15:04] I haven't studied those examples closely enough to do a comparison with something like the Danielson Framework. But it's mapping out those standards across levels of performance is critical, even from a developmental standpoint, because you don't know which teachers need to receive professional development unless like a teacher should be able to recognize their own inadequacies just as the principal should. And mapping out those standards across levels of performance can give both a common language to say, look, here's what we mean by low performance on standard one. Here's what we mean

[03:15:42] by excellent performance. Do we agree? Do we not agree? And actually the answer to that question can lead to its own form of professional development. So to go back to the bigger question, I get there's so many of the right ingredients that I see in the policy documents that I've reviewed, and I think that maybe offering some counter examples like Ann suggested just might help illustrate some of those, like, specificity or prescriptive ideas that we were mentioning.

[03:16:16] You know, Ann, to your question, again, a great one, we'll look more into this. There's no evidence that says that this state system produces improvements in teacher instruction more or less than another state system i think what's particularly will be particularly informative about this sort of state

systems is the design in in terms of the choices of measures the associated weights that that have been assigned and again i think importantly the consequences for low performance given the existing evidence that you know additional instructional support for low performing teachers helps those teachers improve so thinking about ways to target scarce

[03:16:51] resources in ways that are just you know allocated to those teachers and those school settings that likely would benefit from them the most so again thinking both about the the way that these state systems can inform the design but importantly the way that these state systems and the districts that they work with um allocate their existing resources towards supporting instructional development among the the most struggling teachers again to dr lane's point we're not going to fire our way out of this problem and i totally agree with that but we can to the extent that we are able and willing can help support the instructional development of our our need of our lowest

[03:17:28] performing teachers so you know great question anybody else you know i'm going to go home tonight if i don't ask this and i'm sorry to ask you one more uh you know and i'll be upset with myself you have the statement that evaluation for teacher development didn't affect student achievement in average schools but mostly in increased achievement substantially in relatively disadvantaged rural schools. You know, one of the sort of prescribed SOQs we have is geared to

[03:18:03] sort of changing the teaching mix, right, bringing more experienced teachers into what I guess you would consider here the relatively disadvantaged schools. If that occurs, will we still see any significant bump from, you know, a relatively, you know, labor-intensive, costly evaluation system, Or will we have solved this issue a different way?

[03:18:28] Remember, our goal is student achievement, right? And I know one way you get there is improving teacher efficacy, but it may not be the only way. You know, changing the mix might, you know, have a significant bump up also. So I think the mix, the composition of teachers by experience matters, right?

[03:18:45] Pure effects matter, right? But we also know that teachers make their most significant instructional growth in the first six, seven, eight years of their career. So thinking about not only the role that more expert or experienced teachers can play in providing this sort of distributed leadership around instructional improvement, but also targeting those efforts, you know, in more intense ways to our early career folks.

[03:19:11] And I think it could do two things. One, it could address this concern about teacher turnover. If we invest in teacher instructional growth early in the career, teachers are likely to become more invested in the profession, supported in the profession, and then less likely to leave the profession. the profession. And then there are also downstream and direct effects on student outcomes. So thinking about, again, not a sort of a one size fits all approach, if you will, but also a more targeted, you know, distributional approach to identifying and then distributing the supports and resources to those teachers and those communities that are likely to have the greatest marginal effect as a result of those efforts. Okay. So again, then you're talking about not

[03:19:49] really a statewide evaluation system but a targeted evaluation system uh to those places where you have greater effect and i guess what i'm asking is is that better or worse you know i don't think the distinctions between a statewide or not so this is still a statewide system in that the the design of the system is statewide and is required to be implemented at the local level but within that state design system

right efforts and design elements that attend to the fact that again our early career teachers are going to benefit the most from intense professional development support what does this look like in the on the ground this could be again success point to the

[03:20:27] point that we made about the distribution of observations by teacher tenure providing more and more intensive observations and support for early career teachers and maybe like chicago does less frequent observations for our more experienced and higher performing teachers so again recognizing that we have a minimum threshold in terms of the number of observations we might want to conduct for each teacher maybe it's two but then adding on right topping off in cases where we know that teachers and students are going to benefit the most schools serving our most economically disadvantaged kids teachers who are you know newest to the profession communities again that

[03:21:05] may have concerns about teacher turnover and using you know these instructional supports to build both as you mentioned mr gecker efficacy in the profession but also attachment to the profession and you know in this effort to build longevity among our as dr lane focused on longevity we have the mentorship program concept and i guess maybe this will become more clear to me when you guys actually release the hunter and bowser study that's cited for the missouri proposition and you know we just haven't seen it sure you know look for it i know it's not out yet uh and maybe i'm misunderstanding some of the words you're using in the summary you know to mean something other

[03:21:42] than they mean in the study. So, and the question about, I'm not aware, the question was about if you had basically two choices and you could introduce an evaluation system or introduce, I'm not familiar with the other policy you mentioned about the mix, changing the mixture. Let's assume that you could get our poorer schools to hire more experienced teachers. That is, you provided the funding to cause that to happen or, alternatively, you provided them the funding to reduce class size substantially and had younger teachers. But for the moment, let's go with the former, right?

[03:22:19] That you were able to attract high-quality teachers with experience into poorer areas. And that became such that the mix of teachers, right, in terms of experience level or efficacy level, however you want to phrase it, is the same throughout each of the schools, right? You would anticipate an increase then in overall student achievement, certainly in the poorer schools, because you've increased in theory the you know the quality of the teaching in those schools by doing this because you know there's certainly enough evidence to suggest that younger teachers as you guys point out i mean they're they're younger it doesn't mean they're not good teachers

[03:22:56] it just means they're at a different point on their career path and therefore not maybe not quite as able to raise up the disadvantaged student in the same way that a more experienced teacher might so if we were able to equalize you know across across the state the mix of teachers what impact, how would that change the impact of your proposed evaluation system on student achievement, not on teacher teaching quality. I get the idea that teachers ought to respond to all of us. I was a practicing lawyer. We responded to mentorship. That's what we do.

[03:23:33] And we hopefully get better at the craft just like teachers ought to get better at the craft. But now when we're weighing, I hate to say it, part of it is bang for the buck. You've You've got to understand the cost of the systems and the benefits of the systems and be able, therefore, to make some choices.

[03:23:54] I think what you're proposing is the next great research study that needs to be done because, frankly, I don't think either of us are aware of any evidence that has provided that type of contrast. All the

research has typically been a contrast of, like, a prior generation system relative to what changes after introducing or in the way you're talking about redistributing teachers.

[03:24:18] it again is is kind of what happens before and after but an interplay between the two we could certainly make and this is not something we can do off the top of our heads but we could look at some evidence and make a our best evidence-informed uh guess but i'm i don't think either of us are aware of research that has made the type of comparison that you're yeah it's hard to know a system-wide compositional change in the distribution of teacher effectiveness as you're suggesting what the effect of that will be not just on individual schools but on the system you know as a whole we don't know if we move all of our or you know if we equal if every

[03:24:58] school in the state of virginia had the same share of teacher experience same share of teachers by experience let's say whether that's going to change the distribution of student achievement positive negative or unchanged at this point so i think right so that's really the question that you're asking that's clear i mean isn't it fairly clear that it would improve certainly the disadvantaged schools i mean you have a lot of research it would yeah so you can imagine it what you don't know is the offset in the school that's my point we don't know the net effect so the net you don't know right you certainly know you've got an up here we can and you don't know if you have a down over right right in the other right to the extent that lower performing students

[03:25:36] benefit more from teacher quality improvements than higher performing students you might imagine on the margin there could be some additional gains from that type of redistribution but at the same time you know you're also changing other types of mixes right so we know for example from from work that you know early elementary students who are exposed to same-race teachers benefit more right so how might the change in the composition of teachers affect that dimension so there's so you thinking you're asking a partial equilibrium question when it's really a general equilibrium question which is well on net what's the effect on student achievement from moving teachers based on experience or performance but there are other dimensions that might also

[03:26:16] affect student achievement right when we change the composition of teachers but it's again it's an empirical question which is set said we just don't know at this point what we would put our money on is investing in the instructional development of our early career teachers of our struggling teachers of our teachers in school serving our most disadvantaged kids we would i would agree with 90 of that the other piece that i would not necessarily agree with is that those teachers ought to be the ones teaching our most disadvantaged kids i know that's the way it is today but it is not necessarily the way it ought to be going forward which teachers i'm sorry the you know teachers i believe we ought to have teachers with higher

[03:26:54] ability teaching our most disadvantaged kids selection right yeah christopher could i add to that another scenario to add a variable here would be that all experienced teachers may not have the disposition to work in the high poverty school they may not have that ability to to um reach down and and do the the deeper levels of service than what they would elsewhere i understand And again, we're talking about sort of the large numbers as opposed to individual instances.

[03:27:31] Well, I think we've probably exhausted you guys. No, no, no. This is great. We appreciate the opportunity to have this conversation. I was hoping we could do this just for another 15 or 20 minutes to get you right in the heart of the traffic going out of here north. I'll send you my Uber bill. Yeah, please.

[03:27:46] I mean, we certainly appreciate greatly you're taking the time to come down and talk with us. Thank you for the opportunity. Thank you. if there's follow-up please yeah this is something that we work on and hope to continue to work on and we appreciate the conversations with dr lane over the last year around these questions so the extent to which we can continue to support your efforts please please reach out if you could even send me a non-disclosable copy of the missouri study i'd sure appreciate it yes i know it's not peer-reviewed yet but uh huh what they can't commit to doing that oh some guy named seth hunter wrote that. I'll get in touch with him and see what he says. Thank you. I appreciate it greatly.

[03:28:25] Thanks. Thanks, everyone. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you. Thanks, Ann.

[03:28:48] Thanks, everyone. Thank you. Yeah. And where are you all from? I know you're from around the state. I'm actually here in the Richmond region. Far southwest, northern Virginia. Okay. My son is in fourth grade so we're learning all about this is only my third year in state so we're learning all about virginia geography now the appalachian plateau i remember that but all you need to know is there's northern virginia and everywhere else oh i wouldn't say that where are you from

[03:29:22] oh you are okay oh that's appalachian plateau right southwest and you're southeast richmond richmond okay okay are you from here yeah chesterfield okay great thank you thanks again OK, status update on the implementation of the culturally competent educators legislation, Dr. Atkins and Ms. Coy, Assistant Superintendent for Policy and Communications.

[03:29:50] Good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President Wilson, board members, and Dr. Lane.

[03:30:06] Thank you for having us today. We'd like to give you a status update on Senate Bill 1193 and House Bill 1904, the culturally Competent Educators legislation. In this update, we'd like to do a legislative review of the requirements. And in that review, we'll give you the department's status update on the superintendent, principal, and teacher evaluation protocols, along with licensure and endorsement updates.

[03:30:39] We will also give you the process and the development for the draft Board of Education guidance document for local training. We'll then provide you next steps in those processes and answer any questions that you may have. Holly?

[03:31:01] Thank you, Dr. Atkins, and good afternoon again, everybody. So just by way of refresher, the legislation that passed during the 2021 special session, the first special session, I should say, had four components to it. And these legislative requirements touched on teacher evaluation on licensure on endorsement requirements for those seeking an endorsement in history and social science as well as a local training requirement and the last one is is where we'll spend some of our time this afternoon each of those pieces of

[03:31:38] the legislation come with different policy levers and different mechanisms for implementing them so on this slide you will see the mechanism for implementation related to each of those requirements as well as the status and upcoming actions on where we are with that and we'll dive into those in a bit more detail here the first item there relates to evaluations for superintendents principals and teachers this is the component of the legislation that is your your part of the work is largely complete so as you all know you updated the teacher evaluation standard

[03:32:17] back in the spring and the handbook has been updated and published the principal and superintendent practitioner groups are continuing to meet this fall and we anticipate coming before you

in the beginning of 2022 with updates for their evaluation criteria criteria consistent with what you did with the teacher evaluation criteria the department is also working to facilitate and host trainings with the field throughout the spring of 2022 on teacher principal

[03:32:51] and superintendent evaluation system updates the next two items are pretty quick updates in that not a lot has happened since you all took action earlier this summer so with regard to the licensure regulations back in june and july you considered those and you issued a nora to initiate the licensure regulations review those are currently under review by the governor's office as part of the apa we anticipate that the proposed stage would come back before you

[03:33:27] really early winter at this point as they're still sitting there you may recall that for licensure we are reviewing you issued in nora so we'll go through the entire regulatory process THERE FROM START TO FINISH AND THROUGH KIND OF A STANDARD REGULATORY REVISION THERE.

[03:33:46] HOWEVER, FOR THE NEXT COMPONENT, FOR HISTORY AND SOCIAL SCIENCE, THE ENDORSEMENT REQUIREMENT PIECE, THIS SUMMER YOU ALSO APPROVED REGULATORY ACTION THAT WAS ACTUALLY A FAST TRACK ACTION WHICH PUTS IT ON A LITTLE BIT OF A DIFFERENT TRAJECTORY. HOWEVER, THAT ONE IS ALSO CURRENTLY STILL UNDER REVIEW BY THE GOVERNOR'S OFFICE. AND AS SOON AS THOSE COME BACK AROUND TO US, we will bring to you the the next steps in each of those and they'll look a little different since we're using different mechanisms for the two requirements and then the last requirement from

[03:34:25] the legislation has to do with this local training and and with that local training requirement the legislation requires that you all issue guidance by december 31st 2021 to support our local school divisions as they help their staff meet that training requirement you may recall that the training requirement is such that every licensed school board employed individual at a division has to receive that training for the first time by the start of the 22 school year and so

[03:35:02] the timeline here is a pretty quick one you all will provide your guidance later this fall and divisions will then start working to get the local policies in place the trainings in place before the start of the 22-23 school year just a little bit about that guidance and where we are in the process we have been collaborating internally across departments at the agency as well as with our colleagues from the governor's office and secretary's office We have convened a small stakeholder work group and Vice President Wilson graciously serves on that

[03:35:42] as a connection back to the board as do a number of other stakeholders. And they have been providing input since this summer to the department as we work on drafting that guidance. Just at the end of last week, they saw a draft of the guidance for the first time and provided their feedback to us and we're working on incorporating that feedback and refining it.

[03:36:05] This is definitely an iterative process as we work our way through. And our next steps are, like I mentioned, to incorporate that feedback, to share it with an even broader set of stakeholders before we then bring that back to you for discussion and a final decision point before the end of the 2021 calendar year per the legislation.

[03:36:30] I will just note that that guidance does include And we are working on a standard definition for cultural competency as the legislation did not provide a standard statewide definition. It also includes some some core micro competencies.

[03:36:45] What should teachers, principals and administrators be able to do in this area? And how do we lay that out for divisions as they work with their staff to provide that training and meet the legislative mandate?

[03:37:02] SO WITH THAT, I WILL PAUSE AND INVITE ANY QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS FROM YOU ALL. QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS. DR. WILSON. SO I HAVE ENJOYED THE OPPORTUNITY TO SIT IN THIS SMALL WORK GROUP ALONGSIDE MEMBERS OF THE VDOE STAFF, BUT ALSO DR. LAURIE MCCULLAH AND SEVERAL OTHER OF OUR GREAT COLLEAGUES ACROSS THE STATE.

[03:37:26] AND PARTICULARLY AS WE'VE WORKED WITH THE LEGISLATION ITSELF TO ENSURE THAT WE ARE uh reflecting the intent of the legislation but also taking into account um thinking beginning to think through what implementation might look like and how our colleagues um in buildings and in divisions will interact with this information so i'm looking forward to the further feedback that we'll receive as a small group and then ultimately what comes here to the board so i want

[03:37:58] to thank dr atkins and miss coy and others for their leadership in all this uh thank you anybody

[03:38:07] else if not thank you so much you're very welcome mr lanza you guys here does this sound okay okay

[03:38:48] great thank you president gacker dr lane members of the board good afternoon uh my name is ed lanza i'm the director of budget i'm here to brief you on the progress of the um the rebenchmarking process of the direct aid budget for the 2022-2024 biennium uh i know you guys have had a long afternoon so i'll i'll do my best to be brief but uh where i will not be brief uh will be in expressing my appreciation for the folks who uh did most of the real work on this uh budget office

[03:39:23] analyst stephanie caldwell and melanie lore i can't express enough appreciation for the work that they did which began in may um and ended only a couple of weeks ago uh i'll take you through some of the steps that are unique to this particular uh this particular biennial re-benchmarking process uh and a special thanks to really the office of systems development uh for their technical support especially dave hanslick and his team uh they are truly some of the best at what they do and they were instrumental in allowing us to complete the work that we were doing uh before

[03:40:02] I get started, I'll quickly brief you on what this process really is. This process is technical in nature. In other words, no policy. We're specifically updating steps. We do this incrementally in order to isolate the state impact for changing one particular data element or a group of related data elements. What this is doing is updating the total calculated cost of an educational program, which will then affect both the state and local share uh the state cost of re-benchmarking for

[03:40:42] the upcoming biennium is 331 million dollars uh you can see the annual breakdown uh on the screen in front of you and i want to talk a little about some of the exceptions this this is probably it's certainly been the most challenging re-benchmarking process uh since i've been at the department and i would argue it probably will be the most challenging that anyone will experience uh and some of those items are on the screen right now primarily the uh the work would involve involved the consolidation of the allegheny and covington school divisions which is effective with the

[03:41:19] beginning in fy 23. a lot of programming uh going on in the background a lot of testing that needed to be done in order to make sure that uh covington data was feeding into allegheny uh there are some pandemic related effects uh particularly spring 2020 sols uh those those testing that testing was

waived so in order to find an appropriate data point uh to use in our model we use the three-year rates of spring 2017 18 and 19. that's particularly important for the prevention intervention and

[03:41:54] remediation program similarly the october 2020 free lunch calculation for the federal government was not made so we had to make a similar adjustment in our formulas using october 2017 18 and 19. another important point is the maintain that we maintained fy 22 no loss funding in the base for the 22-24 biennium the rationale behind that was related to really the timing in which this step was performed it was back in july when there was still a lot of ambiguity about

[03:42:31] where enrollment would potentially head in in the uh in the fall so there was discussion with department of planning and budget and the decision here was to be very transparent about what we were doing and you'll see that in some of the steps we remove it in step two and reintroduce it in step 27. and finally with the enrollment data uh obviously in lower fy 21 enrollment data could wreak havoc with our growth rates so we've actually omitted uh those that those data points from our growth rates and all of the growth rates used in the re-benchmarking process

[03:43:08] are coming from pre-pandemic values this particular screen just shows a summary of data inputs that feed into the model on the left we have the inputs that are updated on a biennial basis and others on the right that are annual funded salaries the support cap cte special education enrollment those types of things are updated by by uh on the biennial basis and uh our enrollment projections are done annually as well as updates to lottery proceeds and uh and state sales tax

[03:43:44] the only way we would really update anything on the left side would be through a legislative action the the best example we have of that would have been the specialized student support that was funded beginning in fy 22. and there's still a little bit of work left to go uh this would includes some upcoming updates to the local composite index which will dictate the state and local share of programs that require a local match in addition to fringe benefits sales tax

[03:44:16] updates as well as lottery proceeds and there's a there's an old chinese proverb that states that the longest of journeys begins with a single step in the case of re-benchmarking it was a five-month journey over the course of 31 steps and uh that's what these next few slides intend to uh to show and we follow the exact same process generally speaking that we normally do we start out by removing some factors from uh from the model including inflationary factors and one-time loss

[03:44:52] you'll see line two has a significant uh negative entry that's related to as i indicated earlier the removal of the fy 22 no loss program which will get linked back which will be reintroduced in step 27. after that we will move on to enrollment based steps which i'll get into in a little more detail they they encompass steps five through nine uh beyond that we begin looking at some of the data points that come directly from school divisions uh they start with step 10

[03:45:28] and go all the way down to step 18 the this these data points are coming from uh the annual school report uh in this particular case uh base year data is coming from fiscal year 2020. uh then beginning with in steps 19 and 20 uh those are our reintroduction of brand new updated inflation factors those are brought into the model and then the remaining steps 21 through 31 are some of the more targeted programmatic updates including remedial summer school

[03:46:04] esl and then some of our our other programs including a few technical updates that came in uh late into the process and you can see on this fine this slide right here in step 27 that uh we're we're very

being very transparent about the reintroduction of the the no loss into the formula before i move on to some of the more uh specific items in rebenchmarking i did want to talk about the enrollment based steps really in a block um because really at a high level what the soq model

[03:46:43] does is it's computing per pupil amounts and uh so generally in a general sense we've got costs in the numerator and enrollment in the denominator uh step five looks particularly uh abnormal and uh as not to belabor the point of uh impacts to the pandemic i think everyone on the board is familiar with the the decrease to enrollment so what what happened really in step five that makes it look so bizarre is that while some costs in the numerators have been updated

[03:47:18] many costs have not been updated at yet at that point so what's really going on here is we're introducing a lower denominator for many costs in the model and what that's providing is a temporary inflation per pupil amounts in that step which is drastically increasing the cost and you'll be able to see as we introduce more and more data into the model that we actually get back to a relatively comparable effect of enrollment-based steps and you can see that it's really only off

[03:47:53] by about $1 million compared to the previous biennium. And now I just wanted to talk a little bit about some of the very specific factors.

[03:48:08] You can see here student enrollment, again, I referenced earlier the idea that we were going to remove the impact of FY21 on our growth rates. So what you can see here is despite that big drop in FY21, when you look at 22, 23, and you can see that the growth rates being used for the next biennium are very consistent with pre-pandemic levels when you look to the left. In addition to that, we wanted to show us an additional graphic on the right of what enrollment specifically looks like, not just in Chapter 552,

[03:48:46] but what it looks like and what the projections look like in the next biennium. This chart, just we just wanted to make a visual representation and show you what is going on with the three-year free lunch rate to be very specific the three-year free lunch rate is used specifically in the prevention intervention and remediation program and you can see that that increased by about 2.2

[03:49:17] percent over the previous biennium this particular slide here is showing the impact to non-personal support and you can see that it's very clear that non-personal support costs were very much impacted by the pandemic but when you look at the things that were affected they certainly make a lot of sense classrooms instructional classroom types of support costs non-personal support costs primarily would cease after the the school closings in march similar with utilities but

[03:49:52] the reason for the major downturn in non-personal support costs is that those types of costs that that were primarily affected by the pandemic are also some of our largest per pupil amounts amongst the non-personal support costs.

[03:50:13] We always like to show the effect to the support position ratio cap. That's what this particular slide is showing. There, the ratio did decrease from 4.30 in the beginning of the 2022 biennium to 4.19.

[03:50:31] And that ratio means 4.19 instructional positions per support position in the model. That's what it means. And you can actually see a little bit of impact on the attendance and health administrative position due to the specialized student support standard that is now funded beginning in FY22.

[03:51:04] This particular slide is showing the effect of the last couple of biennia on funded instructional salaries. can see that for the most part uh the the track has been very similar the last two biennia really

hanging around about a five percent uh variance between uh from one year to the next it's no coincidence that that matches the uh the maximum uh budgeted uh increase for compensation supplements

[03:51:33] in the last two biennium should be fy uh 20 and fy 22. and finally i'll close with again a quick summary slide that just shows everything that i just talked about a 331 million dollar biennial impact we've got four uh factors that are primarily driving costs uh prevailing salaries support positions health care and inflation we also have some primary decreasing uh factors in here including the non-personal support costs and our pupil transportation uh there are still a few more

[03:52:11] to go a few more steps to go including fringe benefits lottery proceeds sales tax estimates as well as a local composite index and again the the total estimate includes the reintroduction of the no loss in fy 22. um so uh i think that concludes everything i had to say and i'll take any questions i have a vague recollection of the last time this was done it was a number that was in the half a billion range is that right that's 600 million biennially okay so what are the

[03:52:51] implications for us or for the general assembly of the number being significantly lower this biennium well uh president gecker thanks for the question i think the first part really has everything to do with the the way the the no loss has been reintroduced into the budget because uh as we indicate in the slide it's a non-distributed amount so um and that's really a placeholder to guard against uh really the state having to find state funds in the event that enrollment returns in the fall because that's going to affect our updated projections of enrollment uh really in

[03:53:25] the next month as we develop the governor's budget um beyond that again this is uh information everything we i presented today has been provided to uh department of planning and budget and is currently being used in their uh their decisions on policy for the upcoming biennium i'm not sure if i answered the full question did i no that's that's all right i mean go ahead certainly we have no idea what dpb might have been projecting prior to the budget process as they were putting together summaries with a number this low and frankly if you back out the no loss it's almost no impact

[03:54:05] it's break even without no loss uh it means that potentially more funds are available for other priorities and would would those likely go education priorities or would they go elsewhere now that is a policy decision for others than us right well you get paid the large dollars we put in our recommendations as i stated earlier fair enough dr lane if i might add we may want to mention the uh recently recommended reduction in the vrs rate from the vrs board that was released last week for for the 22-24 biennium which is almost a two two percent percent two percentage

[03:54:42] point reduction, and that's going to be a substantial savings on the state bottom line, as well, and localities. It opens up more room for localities to match, potentially. Good. Ms. Halton? Thank you. Ed, if you can go back to slide 13, at least that's on the copy I'm looking at, the one that has the student enrollment percentages.

[03:55:05] This one? So, you know, yeah, I think so. i can't see it but um uh that has that drastic three percent drop in 21 and then and you have over on the right year and enrollment so i mean just to state the obvious and make sure i'm understanding this correctly we are seeing uh even though you're now projecting small increases for 22 23 and 24 the net effect of the drop the big drop in enrollment in 21 is expected to continue

[03:55:42] to impact total enrollment going forward for multiple years. If I remember correctly, we were up to almost 1.3 million in FY19 or thereabouts. So this has us by FY2024, you know, still significantly down from pre-pandemic.

[03:56:04] I mean, like, you know, 5%, 6%, something like that. Does that and and am I right that you know in the way we're benchmarking works We're talking about the total cost of educating the students. So if we're educating fewer students, then Then the total cost is less Now where those students have gone and whether they're going to come back That's what you're trying to accommodate somewhat by the no law. Am I making any sense? Yeah, miss Holton if I if I may The the most significant data point still to come is going to be that September 30th

[03:56:42] 2021 fall data point because when we've made our enrollment projections in In July, we're still missing a very significant data point and there's still at that moment A lot of ambiguity about what was going to happen to enrollment in the fall. So when we get that data point it's going to affect the enrollment projections also for 23 and 24.

[03:57:08] So if we were to see that students returned to school back to pre-pandemic levels, you're likely to see using our pre-pandemic growth rates, you're likely to see increases in 22, 23, and 24 in our projections.

[03:57:26] But right now, with a lack of sufficient data to be able to really think about what really happened, You could argue that the current projection model saw basically a downward shift in enrollment as opposed to a blip.

[03:57:45] If the enrollment comes back, then we'll know it was a blip. And then our data points will start from that point and project forward from there. And to answer your specific question, Ms. Holden, that's why we did the no-loss funding, so that just in case it comes back that full 3%, we have the money left in the model to be able to make up that difference.

[03:58:06] To be clear, the actual enrollment spiked at 1.25 million students. We were about 50,000 students below 1.3 million. We never got quite that high. When you add pre-K and some other things, maybe it got close to there.

[03:58:24] But we're only about 40,000 down. Okay, so I'm looking at the school quality profile state report, and it got up to 1.29, but that must be including pre-K. Yeah, yeah. I don't know. It includes pre-K and kindergarten, but not a lot of pre-Ks, but maybe that number is a slightly different measure, but I hear you. The comparable number to what's on slide 13 for

[03:58:51] FY19 was only 125. Yeah, the chapter 1289 budget was $1.25 million. Okay, so a difference, but not a huge difference. Okay, thank you. Dr. Robertson. Thank you. At the VAS meeting yesterday, a fall legislative conference, Jim Reginball and Jim Roberts made a presentation and which

[03:59:21] appeared to advocate for since state and schools have a great deal of flexibility with one-time money flowing to them from different sources, making a large payment instead to VRS since that would then accrue benefits to school systems over the long term by by having that pay down uh do you do you imagine that that might be a strategy at the state level of course i'm asking you to

[03:59:55] look into a crystal ball uh you did just say kent of course that the rate uh has been reduced already i would you think they're beating appetite for further reduction of of the rate by taking some of

this flexibility and paying down dr roberson i you're right that that one is going to be difficult to answer but um the just a couple of years ago um there was a large pot of flexible money in the lottery um and um within the last couple of years that was made a little more

[04:00:29] restrictive um so i i can't i can't answer that specifically but the most recent example of flexible money was made a little more restrictive in the last couple of years that's all i can really that's all i really have to the only information i have available to remotely resemble an exam an answer okay we appreciate it very much thank you thank you

[04:00:58] this webb that's it since you put yourself last on the agenda you will say that again since you put yourself last on the agenda i know well i've got to be here if you're here so i might as well go last good afternoon president gecker dr wilson members of the board and dr lane i'm pleased to be

[04:01:29] before you this afternoon to discuss your 2021 annual report this report is required by 22.1-18 of the code of virginia and presents the needs of public education an update on the board's work over the past year and provides an overview of student achievement much of this draft focuses on the impact of the covid19 pandemic on our schools and students and the priorities discussed during your september board meeting the priority sections of the report include information on return to in-person learning enrollment impacts staffing challenges unfinished learning due to

[04:02:07] the pandemic student mental health digital equity and education funding the report also highlights the board's work on the standards of quality the comprehensive review of the soa early childhood care and education and other key items from the past year this draft does not include the executive summary or the reports required in the code that traditionally make up the appendices as those items will be added in advance of final review with that i'm happy to either open the floor up

[04:02:42] for discussion for your feedback and your edits um or to go through the report um through each section if that would be your preference miss wilson or dr wilson excuse me i just have a question and it kind of is spurred by the last conversation the last presentation and thinking about overall school enrollment this goes into the category of i'm not sure what to do with this i'm not full of answers today but school enrollment and in the front matter of the report we talk about pandemic

[04:03:17] and its impact um where we've seen our students in terms of being remote hybrid now coming returning and our desire to see people return to fully online or fully face-to-face but my sense is i don't have any data but my sense is that we do have school divisions and schools that for some students are embracing this notion of online and hybrid learning in ways that they had not necessarily pre-pandemic and as we think about the needs of our schools to what extent does that

[04:03:52] fit and it may not fit at this moment but maybe thinking forward maybe this is in the category of for next time around you know maybe we should be thinking or keeping an eye on what's happening and understanding how divisions are making choices for their students or responding to what families are saying instructional needs of their students are dr lane do you know if we have any of that kind of data um that that's something we could could talk about now i'm i'm gonna be honest i don't know yeah and i will just you know say again i don't know that this

[04:04:29] fits into this particular report but maybe it does fall into the category let's keep our eye on it and um then reflect it perhaps going forward if we see that there is this uptake um that i seem to you know there seems to be a growing growing conversation around that yeah just an observation and i will note you

know right now school divisions do have to provide you know that in person and that that virtual option you know that may not be a reality for some school divisions long you know long term you know and certainly putting some regulations around virtual

[04:05:09] education is going to be an important aspect of that as well that's all i have mr no thank you i'm just going back through to make sure there's nothing i've got that i want to bring up but i should be more attentive here dr mann well thank you uh thanks it's great to see the information on the early ed front and i know there's more information to come i do think there is an opportunity and i'd be happy to you know think about this at the very beginning as we're talking about some of the pressure points around staffing challenges i think amplifying the reality of those

[04:05:46] impacts on the early ed side in the same way i just as we talk about outcomes and what we're seeing there it's important that the public understands the same kinds of pressures that we're articulating around what's happening in k-12 with teachers that that we've got to keep a face on that so absolutely happy to um think about how to offer up some language for your consideration yeah absolutely be happy to work with you and obviously jenna and her team on on making sure that that's part of those staffing challenges making sure that we're fully integrating early

[04:06:21] childhood into really every section that we're talking about here since that is now under your purview somebody else wow guys i know there's more i mean it's good but it's not that good well you know i think and as you mentioned oh and go ahead well i just have one little one but i think the truth is i'm brain fried i don't know about everybody else but am i right we have

[04:06:55] a second crack at this tomorrow so maybe we'll be uh but i have just one under the uh enrollment trends enrollment impacts for local divisions um the second sentence says since public education funding is largely based largely allocated uh the second phrase says enrollment declines will negatively impact local school division budget i'd like to qualify that because it does sort of depend on general assembly action like um so we'll likely you know if they follow their normal

[04:07:29] funding but you know obviously what they do in terms of recognizing enrollment loss so so maybe just a qualifier enrollment declines will likely negatively impact or something like that and then and then my other trend i'm just confused because uh i thought your text was uh in terms of uh yeah your text in terms of the enrollment drop 38 000 is consistent with what dr lane was telling me based on what we just heard in the prior presentation, but then those enrollment trend drops, those are much bigger,

[04:08:05] you know, 18% in pre-K, 12%, in other words, all of those are big, that 40,000 equated to a 3% or so overall drop, I think, on Mr. Lenz's chart, and this has 3% being -- well, maybe -- I'm sorry, maybe I'm missing grade levels.

[04:08:25] yeah miss holton i the what we're showing is that the drops were more acute at the lower grade so correct you saw a 12 000 drop in kindergarten but it might only be three or five thousand in other grades i stand corrected so i'll go back to i'm too brain fried to be useful today sorry all right i think as miss holton mentioned we have uh this on first review tomorrow and then not final so we have actually two more shots in theory at it um you know i talked about this before this is one of of the few documents we have that sort of speaks for the Board, you know, very publicly

[04:09:04] speaks for the Board. I'm not going to tell you that I've had enough time either to sort of go through and, you know, worry about, Emily says, sort of the grammar and the word choices and things,

but I have gone through enough to believe that you've certainly covered the topics that we asked you to cover. You know, maybe some, we'd highlight some things a little bit differently.

[04:09:28] For example, just one of my pet things is the lack of real standards for virtual education. I know it's in here, but it also is subsumed and included in the digital divide, the lack of service, which to me is a very different issue than our ability to teach it.

[04:09:50] One is access, which is clearly an important thing, but I don't want people to conflate that with, you know, what does good virtual education look like? Because we do believe, I think, that it's here to stay. I mean, it's been here for a long time, but I mean meaningfully here to stay in terms of the number of our students taking it. And so there may be a few things like that we want to, and again, I'm not speaking for the board on this, just for me, that I would want to see us change and highlight. But overall, I'm pretty comfortable with, you know, this is the first draft. I look forward to seeing the data that's going

[04:10:25] to get filled in, and, you know, we'll tinker with the words as we have in years past, but for all of you, this is an impactful thing. I know often it seems like we do this stuff and it disappears into the great void that is, you know, but it doesn't, you know, sooner or later as education issues come up, somebody's going to pull it off the shelf and say, this is where I saw that statistic, or this is where I saw that argument, and so although it's not immediately obvious that this is a benefit for us to be fairly careful about how we approach this I think is a really good thing in terms of you know how we look and frankly how we move the direction of education

[04:11:04] and the common law and I will say you know obviously we're going to be adding additional data right as it comes through one thing that we're not going to have that I know would be important to the board is around staffing shortages beyond teachers we we won't have that information until sometime in december i know that that was an important piece to highlight which we've tried to provide some anecdotal evidence um but having that kind of real hard data is just not something we're going to be able to include in this report which you know i know we wanted to be able to do

[04:11:42] okay anybody else for today if not you know i'm really uh impressed that all of you spent this much time here today at five o'clock with nobody in the audience still the hardest working board in the commonwealth uh you know thank you all for your attention to you know each and every issue you know i think it's been a fairly good day for us and i look forward to seeing all of you tomorrow at nine o'clock for the regular business meeting of the board with that we are adjourned thanks ann bye and goodbye all thank you

